

The Glorious Bindu of Mahāmudrā, Sovereign Lord of the King of Tantras of the Great Yoginī

Śrī Mahāmudrātilaka Nāma Mahāyoginī Tantra Rāja Adhipati · Toh 420 · Derge Kangyur
དཔལ་ལག་རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷོ་ལ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་རྒྱ་འབརྩེ་མ་ཆེ་མའི་རྩ་ཀ་རྩལ་པོ་མའང་བདག་

Toh 420 in the Kangyur is a tantra known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Mahāmudrātilaka and in Tibetan as Dpal Phyag rgya chen po'i thig le, which may be rendered into English as the Glorious Bindu of Mahāmudrā. It belongs to the class of Yoginī tantras — among the highest yoga tantras — and takes the form of a dialogue in which a ḍākinī questions Hevajra on the ultimate nature of reality, focusing especially on the esoteric doctrine of the bindu, or sacred drop, and its relationship to mahāmudrā, the great seal of awakening. The text presents itself as a sovereign among tantric scriptures, situating its teachings on the six yogic unions and the nature of suchness within the framework of the Hevajra cycle. As Toh 420 in the Kangyur, it is preserved among the Tibetan Buddhist canonical scriptures transmitted from the Indian tantric tradition.

In the language of India: Śrī Mahāmudrātilaka Nāma Mahāyoginī Tantra Rāja Adhipati. In the language of Tibet: The Glorious Bindu of Mahāmudrā, sovereign lord of the king of tantras of the great yoginī. Homage to the Glorious Bindu of Mahāmudrā.

O Blessed One, the ḍākinī who is wisdom itself,
who opens the heart of the secret lotus,
who dwells within the navel of the secret lotus —
be present as I put my questions to you.

O Hevajra, ocean of wisdom,
whose nature streams through five hundred thousand
and who yourself have declared suchness —
the teaching of the yoginī of the six yogic unions,
the supreme sovereign of omniscience —
that hero I recognize.

Yet what is the ultimate truth?
On that point doubt has arisen in me.
The drop, the bindu, and their mode —
the supreme beyond the merely supreme mode,
discerned through the six yogic unions:

where does it dwell?
Whence does vitality arise?
Where does the vajra-holder dissolve?
What precisely is the vajra-night?
What is the dawn that has arisen?
Where are the time and channel of setting,
and how many are the supreme sovereign?
Tell me the defining marks of time.
What does time accomplish in its aim?
What is the practice of the vowels and consonants?
Whence does the sovereign lord arise?
Teach the distinctions of taste,
and likewise of the joys.
The joys that belong to their respective times —
declare them, O sovereign of the vajra.
How is the dharmadhātu explained?
How, again, is the vajra taught?
How is the sound of the self declared?
What is called the secret, and how so?
What is called the supreme, and how?
Make clear the meaning of delight.
Teach the distinctions of the families.
What are the aggregates and sense sources?
Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Wrathful One,
the lord who is always peaceful —
whence do they arise and where do they abide?
How is the great of the great?
Teach some of the distinctions of the mudrā.
What is Mahāmudrā, and how?
What distinctions of offering are there for the protector?
What is the flower therein?
What kind of offering is sought
for the Great Protector?
What is the Blessed One like
in the maṇḍala of supreme things?
What are the goddesses therein?
Of what sort are the goddesses said to be?

What charnel ground does the Blessed One inhabit?

How are the trees therein described?

The charnel grounds and their trees —
let the sovereign of the Victors declare them.

The protector's inner fire offering,
the rite of the five nectars,
the assembly places of the yoginīs,
and what sound is uttered there —
the very self-nature of the self:
O Great Protector, declare these.

This has been the first chapter, entitled "The Cause of All Tantras," from the
Glorious Bindu of Mahāmudrā.

The Blessed One then declared:

What you have asked is profound and difficult to fathom —
the supreme essence of the essence,
the great secret of all buddhas,
the supreme beyond the supreme, the truly supreme.
The Great God (Śiva) and the rest,
and O Bhaṅgamā — she is a beast of the field.
In the ultimate, you alone
are the vessel, O fair-faced one.
The secret of secrets, the greatly delightful —
listen: I shall explain it truly.

First, by conferring the empowerments upon the student once,
one becomes at that very moment
a certain vessel for the explanation of the great secret.
Without empowerment there is no spiritual attainment —
like pressing sand in hopes of butter.
Whoever, through pride in tantra and scripture,
gives elucidation to one who has not been empowered:
both master and student die forthwith,
and though attainment may have been reached, they go to hell.
Therefore with every effort
request from the guru the meaning of empowerment.
There being empowerment and knowing suchness itself,

wisdom and great compassion,
genuine greatness, heroism,
freedom from miserliness, and a good nature —

One who is fortunate possesses all the defining marks complete:
envy's domain utterly abandoned,
a mind ever possessed of joy,
a mind of singular great desire.

When such a one knows the vow,
then upon such a guru should one rely.
A guru of that kind
should examine the student with careful effort,
just as gold is tested by burning and the rest,
just as a jewel is tested by an expert,
just as a maiden is tested for good health —
in just that way should the student be examined.

Therefore, with every effort,
let each examine the other in turn.
If this is not done, fault arises,
and spiritual attainment will never be reached.

Just as poison, when thoroughly purified by mantra,
is transformed into nectar —
so the student, through empowerment and the rest,
comes to have a body free of stain.

One who confers empowerment
should be regarded as Vajrasattva himself.
The guru should be regarded as an emanation king.
The glorious guru should be regarded as fire.
The guru should be regarded as surpassing even the Teacher.
Regard him as equal to a wish-fulfilling jewel.

Just as, through the ritual union and mantra,
from the crown of the emanation king
one finds jewels beyond measure,
and all poverty is made to cease —
but through wrong ritual union and wrong mantra,

the consort (mudrā) is surely burned —
so too through such a ritual,
through conduct such as the vows and the rest,
the very face of glory, the rich lord of empowerment,
can be found in this very life.

But if it is not so — if there is no reverence —
the fire of speech surely burns one.
Just as fire reduces wood to ash
in a mere instant,
so likewise, if the glorious guru is pleased,
sins are purified in an instant.

In this tantra the supreme is this:
there is a Blessed One who confers empowerment.

The Blessed One declared:
In the sequence of the four empowerments,
three are taught by way of result.
First is the master empowerment — these are one.
Second is the secret empowerment — the supreme.
Third is the wisdom-awareness empowerment.
And in like manner so is the fourth.

The master empowerment is divided into eleven.
The secret empowerment: twelve in the supreme.
The wisdom-awareness: the thirteenth.
And in like manner the fourteenth.

Each empowerment corresponds to one ground,
and those are the lords and sovereigns of the grounds.
This is to be known through the three root causes,
and the result thereof is the fourth.

Or else the result is the separation into three,
or else it is the very three identities.
The distinctions of joy are to be known
in sequence through the cakras.

On the third day of the waxing moon,
one should confer empowerment upon the supreme student.

With a fair face, long of eye,
adorned with a beautiful form in full bloom —
twelve years of age, or sixteen,
or if unavailable, one who has reached twenty is also suitable.
One who is over twenty has a different mudrā,
and that makes spiritual attainment remote.

A sister, or a daughter,
or a wife should be offered to the guru.
Then with various substances,
with faith, one should make offering to the guru:
an excellent variety of hundreds and more,
various precious victory banners supreme,
pearl garlands of priceless worth —
with countless gold should offering be made.

"From this day forward I am your servant" —
with the fourfold great offering of a great lord,
with such a ritual,
with effort one should make offering to the guru.

The guru's form is one's own self.
Having made offering to oneself, one attains spiritual attainment.
Then in that instant, with the great mudrā,
having made offering, one should perform the approach practice.

Whatever arises from that approach practice
should be let down into the student's mouth.
With the thick tip applied at the edge,
it should be brought within and enjoyed.

At that time, authentic primordial wisdom is born.
Such as the bliss of the maiden —
equalizing breath and effort,
one should make offering through supreme delight.

Place the syllables HŪṂ and PHAṬ upon the jewel's mouth,
then set it upon the arrow and release.
At that moment, the instant of joy
arises just as it does by nature.

In this way the mudrā is to be explained. This is the defining characteristic of joy. Then, placing it into the student's hand, one should speak these words: "By my scriptural transmission that is free of conceptuality, act in accordance with the true meaning of the lotus. In the center of the heart of the lotus, the sovereign lady of the vajra sphere (Skt. vajradhātu) abides. Until she is found, there is no awakening through any other means. She is the form of natural joy, the subtlest of the subtle — truly, she is to be worshipped."

From the Glorious Drop of the Great Mudrā (Skt. Śrī Mahāmudrātilaka): this is the second chapter, entitled "Examining the Master and Student, Presenting the Offering Fee, and Conferring Empowerment."

Then the secret is to be explained. The supreme, the most excellent, the highest of the high — the body that is the essential nature of the five aggregates, the six wheels of the sense-faculties' fine delight, the half-moon beautiful form, even as it rains — abides within the wheel of wind. It is neither half nor full, but is seen like the moon reflected in water. The great mother of illusory beings, she is served innumerable even as she rains. She is the supreme and the subtly other-supreme, unborn, non-dual, inconceivable. The mother who generates the wheel of wind — even buddhas find her difficult to find.

Within the wheel of fire there is a single drop, without letters. Everything is contained within, and all letters are within it. It pervades all things and bliss arises from it. It is that which multiplies bliss. It is free of vowels and minor marks. It is the cause that generates the countless three realms. Its nature is the abode of the sudden. It is free of all aspects. Its essence is like a serpent's tongue. It is that which generates the higher realms and the earth. It is not a syllable, nor is there any element; it is free of the ornament of lunar days and the drop. Unborn, innumerable, and inexhaustible — this is the mode of the ultimate truth.

The abode of the wheel of emanation is known as the equalization of the navel. The mere mode of the wheel of Dharma is like an emanation-eye, stainless. It is the abode of the stainless and uncontrived, without location, without aspect. Without motion and beyond expression, without the movement of breath. Its mode possesses supreme primordial wisdom; the thirteen sovereigns do not know it. It abides in the wheel of supreme enjoyment, the supreme aspect, the most excellent ambrosia, located at the boundary of the supreme vehicle — just like the power of wine. All beings are

free of their lovely forms; it abides by way of a formless self. In the wheel of other-supreme great bliss it abides at the outermost limit of all. There is no viewer and nothing to be viewed; all inauspicious signs are absent. Inexpressible, inexhaustible, tranquil and present — such is the aspect of one's own delight and experiential taste. Through the kindness of the lama, one will obtain the wheel of splendid delight. Such great primordial wisdom, having the nature of the six consciousnesses, is explained as the ultimate within the center of the six wheels.

Through the union of above and below, it exists by way of joined beautiful form. Twelve and a half, and half of six, sixty-four, likewise eight, sixteen and thirty-two — this is the lotus wheel of poison.

From the Glorious Drop of the Great Mudrā: this is the third chapter, entitled "The Defining Characteristics of the Six Unions and the Individual Nature of the Six Wheels."

Listen, O goddess of great fortune! The supreme arising of the wheel of channels — seventy-two thousand channels — their classes are hereby explained. In the great tantra of the great lineage I have caused this to be clearly elaborated. Here the count of the six wheels shall be taught in brief summary.

The six channels of the wheel of wind are: the agitated, the sky, fire and hollow, the great revolver, and the greatly fearsome — those channels are the abode of the wheel of wind. The ida (Skt. *idā*), the rasanā, and the conceptuality-free channel — these three abide in a triangular arrangement. Within the wheel of fire, the five channel faculties are to be known.

The swift one, the perfectly swift, the very excellent, the excellent-going, the greatly powerful and greatly fearsome, the greatly proud and the greatly terrifying, the power-swift one, the power-portion, the power-water, the power-fragrance, the power one, the power-flowing one, the friction one, the anointing one, the many-powered, the fierce one that feeds on pride, the sky-goer, the bird-limbed one, the bird-going one, the wealthy one, the fearsome one, the roaring one, the disciplined one, the offering one, the intoxicated one, the sound one, the sound-arising one, the sinful one, the lotus-stalk one, the blue-green one, the essence one, the essence-arising one, the hair one, the opposite-facing one, the staff one, the staff-pride one, the primordial one, the swift-bellied one, the swift-hexagonal one, the seven-swift one, the diligent one, the swift-household one, the swift-mouthed one, the

swift-luminous one, the swift sheep-lineage, the exhaler, the self-one, the luminous one, the stainless one, the fragrance-burning one, the cord-bellied one, the cord-joyous one, the cord one, the various-time cord one, the hollow owl, the hollow-born one, the subtle one, the leaf one, the sharp leaf, the garment-wearing one, and the illuminating one — these eight sets of eight channels are to be recalled. The sixty-four water-born ones abide in the emanation wheel of the navel. The precious one, the great lotus one, the great-tongued one, the greatly powerful one, the great-headed one, the greatly intoxicated one, the greatly joyous one, and the greatly joyless one — these eight, along with the Dharma-wheel water-born ones, flow into the ocean of the beautiful-faced heart center. The desirous one, the enjoyment one, the non-enjoyment one, the sunlight one, the luminous one, the bhaga one, the lū one, the ash-faced one, the food-giving one, the self-eating one, the hungry one, the rasāyana one, the bitter-taste one, the dripping-taste one, the taste one, the bent one — these constitute the abode of the enjoyment wheel. The twice-eight water-born petals belong to the successive class of the throat. The desirous one, the desire-conducting one, the swift-bodied one, the moon-drinking one, the moon-bellied one, the treasury one, the pleasant-voiced one, the mute one, the smoky one, the cuckoo, the hundredfold one, the withered one, the fire one, the hunter one, the moon one, the full one, the sleep one, the sleep-born one, the beer-seller, the beer-giver, the nectar one, the conch one, the conch-eared one, the conch-eyed one, the conch-nosed one, the power-rich one, the power-yellow one, the power-bewildered one, the power-fierce one, the strutting one, and the mountain-based one — these thirty-two abide in the skull, the site of the great bliss wheel, king of all wheels. It pervades all the wheels. All are subtle, without tangible substance, utterly free from apprehended and apprehender. Possessing the character of great bliss and bliss, it bestows great bliss and the rest. The arising of the elements at its root is to be understood by one who truly desires liberation. If the channel-born goddesses were to become non-arising, how could the arising of the aggregates take place? If there are no aggregates, how would the great yogins attain the great gnosis? The five aggregates are the very body of the self. They are well renowned as the five *ḍākinīs*. The five *ḍākinīs* are the five noses, possessed of the intrinsic nature of the five elements. If the channels themselves were to become free of the elements, then the aggregates too would be free of the elements. If there are no aggregates, the *siddhi* (Skt. *siddhi*) would not be attained by the great yogi. Therefore, with every effort, one must seek the wheel of channels. Just as rain

from a cloud causes it to grow ever greater, and grants fruits — many and boundless — without doubt, so likewise is it called the tree of the aggregates: by the water of the channels it grows great, and being grown great, grants the fruit of liberation without doubt. As for the material substance of the goddesses, the channel form is their bodily form. Through the practice of joining with the element of touch and the victory-banner of the vajra, the water-born ones within the fire-wheel are stirred. When the vajra sets them in motion, the fire is absorbed within. All the water-born ones of the wheel become clearer and clearer, and the mouth becomes sealed. Then all the channels flow, like drops of water dripping from a vessel, and then they gather together at the emanation wheel and become one. From the tips of the mouths of the two channels, the moon and sun drip. The channels abide within the womb —

they exist in the form of a rope. That is called the single flowing channel. It divides into two distinct results: from the left flows the seminal fluid, and from the right flows blood. When the sun is on the right side, the bliss becomes red. Because the moon arises from the left, that bliss becomes white. The fire dwelling within those two is like the two faces of a turtle-egg. The karma-wind and consciousness from a former time, when they have entered into cyclic existence, at that moment the mind is transformed within the bhaga through great attachment. When the mother's lunar sign appears, and fire and sun appear clearly, at that moment the mind of great attachment reaches the supreme seventh touch. Having entered into the bolla and kakola, just as water is placed upon water, at that moment the seed arises. From the seed arises a lump of flesh; from that goddess the channels arise, and the fruit arises with certainty.

This concludes the fourth chapter, entitled "The Arising of the Channels of the Six Wheels from the Drop of Glorious Mahāmudrā."

Now listen, O Goddess, as I explain the manner in which the vital breath dissolves into the elements. Even before birth, it dwells within the inner secret meeting-place. That is the wisdom body (jñānakāya) free from consciousness and free from self. From that abode, the vital breath arises — the supreme vital breath of all living beings — ever dwelling as the great self, the vital breath, abiding in the five abodes. It is known as the five spaces. It dissolves into the five spaces. The four great elements are to be understood as the support of the vital breath — or alternatively, the vital breath is their support. O Goddess of Good Delight, know this. From consciousness, wind arises; from

that, fire arises; from that, water arises; from that, earth arises. From all of these the aggregates arise; from there the sense bases arise; from there the nature of wisdom arises, by the sequence of one hundred and eight. This was taught by me previously in the great tantra called the Vajra Garland.

Whatever is night and whatever is day — night I shall explain. Night is known as wisdom, and wisdom becomes night. The form of the fire of night becomes the moon. The moon is of the nature of nirvāṇa. By the two wisdoms — conventional and ultimate — wisdom is to be known. At the conventional level it is to be known as touch. That which is bliss without tangible touch is the defining characteristic that is difficult to behold. That which has the nature of being without inherent nature — that is what I have called night. Daytime is known as skillful means; method becomes the sun. The element of the bhaga is the sun; the sun becomes the lord of the bhaga. The sun is the form of existence; the moon is the form of nirvāṇa. That existence is shown as the family. The family of the moon arises from the sun. Because it is without stain, it is the sun — free from the net of conceptual thought. Supremely subtle without stain, utterly clear, it is the emptiness body (śūnyatākāya). Truly pure, stainless, at rest and at peace, it is present everywhere throughout all things. Such is what I have called the day — the day hidden throughout all the channels.

The junction is the meeting of the two: from vajra and lotus arise sun and moon. The meeting of the two navels is the defining characteristic of a subtle instant. The junction is liberation from affliction — the supreme of supremes, free from all aspects — present between the two of the union, with neither application nor craving. That junction purifies the path of cyclic existence for all sentient beings. The east is called supreme — free from joy and free from what goes with it — the supreme abode at the tip of the knot. The form of the mustard-seed bones: these have two mouths. The east is to be known as the lord of the moon. Because the moon travels upward, it is known as the drop of the moon. The teaching is that the drop divides into four. Abiding in the middle between the first and the last —

the fourth is nowhere to be found. Because it is the very nature of self-cognizing awareness, it is therefore beyond all expression. That is shown as the secret, and the meaning of arising is gathered there.

Listen, O Goddess who grants bliss! I myself now teach the truth of setting.

When the mind sets, it first transforms into the form of the moon. At that time it goes to the place of setting. What does not move comes to move. When what was first goes to become last, that is taught as the setting. The last thing taught as setting is this: in the place of support, abiding without support. When there is support, supreme bliss is present — yet where can there be bliss without support?

This concludes the fifth chapter from the glorious Mahāmudrā Tilaka, entitled "The Teaching on Life, Night and Day, the Junction, and Arising and Setting."

Now first the arising of the root elements is taught. Listen: I shall explain time. Time is taught as measure; divide time into two distinctions. There is time that is beyond conception, and the most auspicious time is time indeed. The very auspicious time and the inauspicious time: the two apertures in the flaring of the nose — the in-breath is taught as the auspicious time, and the out-breath is explained as the time that is not auspicious. The time that is not auspicious is called the cut. The auspicious one is supremely to be held in mind. Free from both: that is suchness, gathered here, unprecedented. It is free from views and free from anything to be viewed, parted from all ill-signs. That time, I shall now, with beautiful and truthful mouth, explain to another.

At that time, if the yogin does not make the mind directed elsewhere, how shall I, the sovereign of sacred commitment, become other than what I am — the vajra-holder?

From where do Āli and Kāli arise? Listen — I shall explain this. They arise from the stainless, genuine abode. They have form that manifests as the spreading of luminosity. Endowed with thirty-three excellent marks, the maṇḍala of Kāli is utterly vivid. From the abode where luminosity spreads, that very luminosity arises in clarity — bearing sixteen vowel-letters: this is the expanded maṇḍala of Āli.

Through the union of these two, great flavor arises gradually. The form of the supreme nectar is the abode of great-bliss bliss. It resides at the tip of the ḍākinī's nose and illuminates the six cakras of the lotus. Its tactile quality bestows bliss — the eight great flavors are to be known: trembling, a sensation of particles, the rising of body-hair, the falling silent of speech, radiance of complexion, the changing of color, and intoxicated tears. These are the eight flavors of the essence.

Being drawn in by flavor, the joys arise as most excellent. Joy, supreme joy, joy-of-cessation, and innate joy — likewise in the same way. What is called joy

is luminosity. Supreme joy is taught as the spreading of luminosity. Joy-of-cessation is called the attainment of luminosity. Innate joy is genuine clear light.

At that very time, in a single instant, arise the defining characteristics of variety and so forth. Luminosity is taught as the moon. Spreading luminosity is the sun. The junction is known as the attainment of luminosity. Free from the three is genuine clear light.

Whenever the mind is within the inner knot, joy arises at that time. From the junction of the knot, at about three units further, supreme joy arises. Going three places from the three, joy-of-cessation arises.

Whatever abandons both sets of three — suchness, whose intrinsic nature has arisen: that is the supreme of the great secret, the genuine supreme of the secret of secrets. In the tantras such as the Saṃvara and the rest, it is to be kept concealed from the beloved goddess of good delight. In the Saṃvara or the Hevajra, it has also not been made clear. This supreme act performed for your sake — this great secret I myself have made clear.

Buddhas, bodhisattvas, and others who have not died — listen, all you afflicted ones: this supreme suchness of that kind, if it is not I myself, is not known. Further, what is renowned as the dharmadhātu — that very suchness, listen — I myself shall explain.

Space is the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena,
and that basic space is understood as the seed.

It dwells within all phenomena
and is the cause and supreme abode.

Just as oil exists within sesame,
and just as fire exists within wood,
so too does the dharmadhātu pervade
all phenomena throughout —
yet if it is present, it cannot be seen from without.

The dharmadhātu is renowned as "bhaga."

Bhaga is the precious vessel.

Endowed with qualities such as sovereignty and the rest,
it is universally known as bhaga.

Dharma is taught under the name bhaga.

The basic space is understood as mind.

Throughout the boundless expanse of the three realms,
mind is the cause of that.

At the level of conventional truth it appears as form,
like the reflection of the moon in water.

At the ultimate level, it is not seen —
yet its not being seen does not mean it is nothing,
for it is not a non-entity.

Self-knowing awareness is supremely peaceful,
free from entity and non-entity alike.

That is the supreme suchness,
the self of the dharmadhātu, peaceful.

Thus ends the sixth chapter of the Glorious Great Seal Bindu
(Mahāmudrātilaka), entitled "The Arising of the Vowels and Consonants from
the Bindu, the Characteristics of Time, and the Presentation of the
Dharmadhātu."

Furthermore, listen — I shall explain.

What truly bears the characteristic of the vajra
is taught as the indivisible vajra,
the supreme very self of the five wisdoms,
absorbed into the center of the five spaces,
the very self of the five spaces.

It abides within the center of the lotus,
a single bindu, without syllable,
free from all aspects and without aspect —
that is universally known as the vajra.

The definitive meaning of the word "self" —
listen, for I shall explain that very suchness.

The syllable A is the supreme among syllabic forms
and dwells within the body of all without exception.
All supreme aspects are perfectly complete in it.
It is present in all, unborn, knowing all,
ever empty, pervading all,
the cause that unifies everything into one.

Existence, supreme existence, the day —
it is the bliss of the emanation body.
The body grants the refuge of the Tathāgata
and is capable of accomplishing all aims.

The syllable Hūṃ is free from form,
dwelling in the body yet not born from the body.
It is liberated from all aspects and without aspect,
free from all major and minor marks,
liberated from entity and non-entity,
the agent of arising and dissolution,
the extinguisher of all entities —
it possesses the intrinsic nature of the dharmakāya.
Mind is the refuge-granting Vajradhāra.
Free from all syllables,
it is the empty aspect, nirvāṇa,
possessing the intrinsic nature of the wisdom body.
Stainless, inexpressible, and peaceful —
that is perfectly accomplished in Hūṃ.

"I" am within the interior of all,
all things are the very self of "I," ever present.
In the very self of all entities
that pervades and abides throughout.
Were "I" absent, all beings
would be like a tree with its root severed.

At the border of the syllable Hūṃ,
the syllable A rests at the crown.
The syllable A is the moon,
the syllable Hūṃ is the light of the sun.
The syllable A is the support,
the syllable Hūṃ is what is supported.
The syllable A is explained as life-breath,
the syllable Hūṃ is understood as exertion.
Whoever unites these two in that place —
for that one the very self will become luminously clear.
Difficult to find in all the tantras,
this is explained as the authentic word "self."

Thus ends the seventh chapter of the Glorious Great Seal Bindu, entitled "The Characteristics of the Vajra and the Definitive Meaning of the Word 'Self.'"

Now the meaning of the secret is to be explained.

What is called "the secret" — what does one say?

"The secret" is presented as joy.

What is called "supreme" is indeed the supreme.

What is called "delight" is presented as free from joy.

Recollect the innate very self of all.

The secret itself is the secret —

the secret is presented as the vital fluid.

The vital fluid is taught as the life-breath,

and the life-breath is understood as the support.

The support is to be known as the earth;

it is the arising of all three realms.

The supreme is presented as water —

Water is the life of the vital breath.

At the end of that, it is taught as light.

Light is recollected as utter purity.

Utter purity is the very substance of great bliss —

that is taught as intrinsic nature.

Utter purity neither arises nor abides.

What descends is said to be pure.

What descends is taught as not being a concrete thing.

What is not a concrete thing cannot be called utter purity.

Utter purity is the subtle of the subtle.

The purity of the subtle abides elsewhere —

it is taught as "the intrinsic nature of the subtle."

Apprehended and apprehender are entirely abandoned.

The great bliss of one's own nature

is supremely renowned as the wind of gnosis.

That is explained as space.

Space is taught as emptiness.

From emptiness all things arise.

Into emptiness all things dissolve.

Emptiness abides in perfect purity, stainless,

free from all aspects,

the supreme aspect, free from arising and pure —

the very substance of self-arising experiential joy.
That is explained as intrinsic nature.
The self of all abides always.

Now, the defining characteristics of the five families —
listen, for I shall explain them.

Family is called kapāla.

Kapāla is explained as ka.

Ka is known as "root."

The root is recollected as fivefold in its distinctions.

The bodies of the five Tathāgatas —
these are recollected as the five aggregates.

The five aggregates are the body of accomplishment,
having the intrinsic nature of the five elements.

Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Fierce One,
Īśvara, and the Ever-Peaceful —
these five are pervaded by the single one.

The self is the ultimate father,
the great emptiness that pervades all.
The self neither transfers nor is born.

Ka is that which drinks compassion.
Pā is that which guards the commitments.
La has gone beyond the lower destinies.
That is explained as kapāla.

The sound ka is intrinsic nature.
Ka does not abide anywhere whatsoever.
It pervades all things.
That is what is taught as ka.
That self is the very substance of Heruka.
It abides in the place of the wheel of Dharma.
The Ever-Peaceful dwells in the enjoyment wheel.
Īśvara is the wheel of great bliss.
The Fierce One abides at the navel wheel.
Viṣṇu is the wheel of fire.
Brahmā is in the wind wheel.
When the wind is present within all,

the self is at the center of the six wheels,
and abides pervading all of them.

Emptiness, the other supreme — emptiness itself —
the supreme of glorious Heruka,
the chief of the five ḍākinīs,
the lord of the wisdom ḍākinīs am I,
having the intrinsic nature of the five elements,
encircled on all sides by ḍākinīs.

This concludes the eighth chapter of the Glorious Great Seal Drop, entitled
"The Secret, the Four Joys, and the Defining Characteristics of the Five
Families."

Then again, what remains to be explained:

The signs of the mudrās are supreme.

Earrings, anklets, and the wheel,
likewise the necklace and the ash —

the sacred thread of Brahmā — these are the six mudrās,
to be recollected as the six perfections.

Generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence,
meditative concentration, and wisdom — these are the six.

Generosity is taught as Dharma.

Moral discipline is recollected as karma.

Patience is recollected as commitment.

Diligence is to be understood as meditative absorption.

Meditative concentration is recollected as gnosis.

What is called wisdom is the great mudrā —
this is to be understood as ultimate.

The six sense bases are to be purified.

They are supremely renowned as the six mudrās.

The six families are to be understood in sequence.

The six mudrās are the very identity of the goddesses:

yaṃ, raṃ, laṃ, baṃ, aṃ, haṃ —

these are in the sequence of the goddesses.

Therein, worship is supremely to be performed.

The worship proceeds in the sequence of equal taste.

By the power of dissolution and enjoyment,
it is likewise for all places.

Caṇḍālī, Cooked-Food, Ḍombī,
the Dancer, the Skull-Bearer, and the Brahmin Woman —
Caṇḍālī belongs to the lotus family.
Cooked-Food is recollected as belonging to the jewel family.
Ḍombī is called the vajra family.
The Dancer is recollected as the sword family.
The Skull-Bearer belongs to the wheel family.
These five are the pure mudrās.

The wisdom mudrā, the Brahmin Woman,
is recollected as belonging to the family of Vajrasattva.
Yet she is not truly a brahmin woman —
the Skull-Bearer is recollected as the sister.
The Dancer is to be understood as the daughter.
Ḍombī is well known as the wife.
The Cooked-Food Woman is the bride.
Caṇḍālī is recollected as the sister-in-law.

By the rite of wisdom and skillful means,
worship is to be performed without conceptual thought.
Without conceptual elaboration, accomplishment is achieved.
In the very instant of approach practice,
the Mother is taught as mind.
Speech is here recollected as the sister.
The Daughter is well known as body.
The Wife is recollected as life-force.
The Bride is recollected as effort.
The Sister-in-Law is recollected as equanimity.

The Mother is the root of power —
the vessel of the precious buddha.
The Sister is the root of semen,
dwelling in the place of the highest.
The Daughter is the root of blood,
present below the root of semen.
The Wife is the root of fragrant water,
dwelling in between the two.
The Bride is the root of tears,
dwelling in the place of the throat.

The Sister-in-Law is the root of mucus,
dwelling in the place of the forehead.

The Mother is to be understood as earth.

The Sister is recollected as water.

The Daughter is recollected as fire.

The Wife is well known as wind.

The Bride is space itself.

The Sister-in-Law is not space.

The Mother becomes the sweet taste.

The Sister is recollected as the sour.

The Daughter is to be understood as the pungent.

The Wife is here recollected as the salty.

The hot is the Bride.

The Sister-in-Law is recollected as the astringent.

All of these are to be worshipped with effort,
and accomplishment will swiftly be obtained.

What is difficult to find in the tantras of yoga,
I have explained in the context of the families of mudrā.

This concludes the ninth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka, entitled
"The Symbolic Language of Mudrā and the Rite of Worship."

Now the rite of worship — I have taught it as outer and inner.

Toward stone and similar objects, and toward stūpas,
one should never make prostration.

Consecration, maṇḍala, and fire-offering —
these too are never to be performed.

Great fragrance, vajra-water, seed-syllables, and the like —
these are always to be offered to oneself.

Whatever moves or does not move,
all of it is mind.

The form produced thereby is not mind;
mind is empty in its intrinsic nature.

Devoid of essential nature, it is empty,
and thus all that moves is established as mind.

Having purified in just this way,
one should also make offering to the channels and so forth.

You yourself are the lord Vajrasattva.
Mind is to be recollected as the self.
What is not mind is the substance of the deity —
there is no other external one.
Having understood it thus, you yourself
should first worship that very suchness.

Conduct yourself completely within the five families;
examine them as a single family.
The distinctions of attachment and aversion,
and the distinction of drinking and not drinking — abandon these.
There is no woman who is an unsuitable vessel.
Do not speak of virtue and non-virtue.
If you desire to obtain the great accomplishment
without accomplishment-yoga, without mantra, and without a mantrin,
do not cultivate such a mind.

A great being of vast waves and profound depth
should cultivate that mind.
The mind that is on a level with śrāvakas —
never cultivate it in that way.
The unstable, those not of the fortune of śrāvakas,
whose wisdom is veiled by the darkness of the wrong path —
to these ones, even a mere word
a great being does not give.
Nor should you go to be criticized by them,
nor ever pay homage to them.

The practice of outer and inner union —
its abiding here I have explained.

The vajra-places are Uḍḍiyāna,
Jālandhara is recollected as a place,
Pūlliramā is a place,
and Kāmarūpa is a place.
Mālara is taught as the adjacent place;
Sindhunagara, Siṃhala,
the field known as Mummuni,
likewise Devikoṭa,
Kuluta as the adjacent field,

Arbuda likewise recollected,
Hārekelā, Chandoha,
Godāvarī likewise,
Lampāka and Kīci —
these are taught as the adjacent Chandoha.
The gathering-place is Karmāra.

Likewise Suvarṇadvīpa is a place,
and Koṅkaṇa and Vindhya —
these are recollected as adjacent gathering-places.
The charnel ground of the preta gathering,
and the charnel ground on the ocean shore;
the adjacent charnel ground is Cāritra,
and likewise Kaumārapā.
Kashmīr is known as Pilavara,
and likewise Kerata is a place.
The adjacent Pila is Nepāla,
the adjacent Pila is Karṇoja.
Uḍḍiyāna is the place of the crown of the head,
Jālandhara is recollected as the fontanelle.
Pūllira is the nape of the neck,
Kāmarūpa is the middle of the collarbones.
Mālava is the tip of the nose,
Sindhu is known as the two eyes.
Nagara is recollected as the two ears.
Siṃgha resides at the lotus of space.
Mumūni is the throat-hollow.
Devīkoṭa is at the neck-island.
Kuluta is at the back-island.
Arbuda is at the two breasts.
Hārikela is the heart.
Gondāvarī is the place of the navel.
Lampāka is the secret place.
Kāñcī resides in the middle of the spine.
Karmālīṅka is at the tip of the spine.
Suvarṇadvīpa is the place of the anus.
Koṅkaṇa is recollected as the two thighs.

Vindhya is the two knees.
The preta-gathering is the tibia,
the ocean shore is at the two ankles.
Kaumārī is the big toes.
Cāritra is at the finger joints.
The land of Kashmir encompasses all the limbs.
Kerata is the sole of the foot.
Nepāla is the heel.
Kapijī is the waist.

These are the ultimate places.

The moon, flame-flowers,
and red flowers, equal to the sun —
at the time of worship one should make offering.
The offering-gift of life-sacrifice
one should present there with earnest endeavor.
At the great lotus lake of that place,
the life should be cut.
One should never make it cease —
great diligence should be applied there.
Through the merit of life-sacrifice,
the supreme of supremes is truly obtained.

At that place, pure and stainless, triangular in form,
there are the two satellites of the maṇḍala.
As the inner satellite: the glorious Blessed One,
endowed with bodhicitta itself.
The outer: the yoginī of the three families —
the holder-goddesses and the rest, greatly supreme.
Since they arise from within the body,
they are taught as goddesses.
The maṇḍala is taught as the body,
and the vulva is explained as the maṇḍala.
The maṇḍala is the awakening mind —
these three maṇḍalas are to be understood.
Dwelling in the midst of eight charnel grounds,
these three maṇḍalas are to be meditated upon.
The breathing-out charnel ground, as it is called,

is furnished with nine gates.
Listen well, Beautiful-Faced One —
I shall explain the arising of these.

The fierce and violent one, anus-shaped,
is the secret vaginal opening.
The charnel ground called "The Blazing"
dwells in the two nostrils.
Hell and such — likewise the unbearable —
these dwell in the two eyes.

The raucous ha-ha and the gaping
dwell in the two ears.
In each charnel ground there is one tree,
and in it there is one who holds power.
The fierce and violent one: the palmyra tree,
and the inner form is the śikara.

The vaginal opening is the śāli-tree.

"The Blazing" is the śorisa tree.

Hell and such is the udumbara,
the unbearable is the pāṭali tree.

In the raucous ha-ha is the aśvattha,
and in the gaping the kesara tree.

These sixty-four forms of trees
each have many branches.

The woman of anus-power, fire-powered tip,
the mountain-peak, the corpse-bodied woman,
the sky-woman, the rain-giving woman,
the decayed woman, and the hungry woman —
these are recollected as divided into eight varieties.

The word "tree" means root,
because a tree has flowers.

On the supreme maṇḍala above,
if there are no flowers, how can one make offering?

This concludes the tenth chapter, entitled "The Maṇḍala, the Goddesses, the Sacred Sites, the Charnel Grounds, the Trees, and the Offering," from the Glorious Great Seal Drop.

Now listen — I shall explain the fire-offering
that eliminates all afflictions.

There abides a manner at the place of the navel,
and by that manner, at the outer rim is the secret lotus.

There, the wind of self-ignition
is made to circulate, then comes to rest.
Through the joining of the two faculties like rubbing sticks of wood,
the wind kindles the fire.

The wheel above where butter is present
is recollected as the vessel of butter.
Ha is explained as the ladle for pouring.
The full ladle is here shown as the vajra.
The fire-offering pit is explained as the bhaga.
The grain is recollected as the five faculties.
The yamwood is shown as the aggregates.
The awakening mind is burned as the butter.

Below the face of the butter,
descend until reaching the fish, and offer.
The drop, filling the ladle only halfway —
do not let it pass outside the fire-offering pit.

The buddhas, the bodhisattvas,
the gods, the asuras, the rākṣasas,
and the eight world-guardians —
all of these are to be fully satisfied with the oblation.

Whatever offering is made to the vajra-mind,
it should be presented filled with the substances of burning.
By mantras of the Hūṃ Phaṭ variety,
the skilled one should offer the burning substances.

By this, the ḍākinīs
and likewise the yoginīs are pleased.
Whatever is conceived in the mind,
immeasurable great siddhis are bestowed.
All wishes are fulfilled.
Such is the fire-offering that I have explained.

This concludes the eleventh chapter, entitled "The Rite of the Ultimate Fire-Offering," from the Glorious Great Seal Drop.

Now, I shall explain in brief
the supreme rite of the five nectars.
Vairocana, Akṣobhya, Amoghasiddhi,
Amitābha, and Ratnasambhava — these are shown as five.
Ratnasambhava is indicated as blood.
Amitābha is spoken of as semen.
Amoghasiddhi is great flesh.
Akṣobhya is vajra-water.
Vairocana is explained as great fragrance.
These, then, are the five nectars.

In a place of solitude, empty of people, joyful,
free from all harm —
there, one should thoroughly prepare a house,
two-storied and provided with a door.
One story is to be below ground,
and the second is above it.
Worldly people know it as one.
In such a manner should the skilled one make the house.

First, for the practice, one who is of fortunate capacity,
greatly learned and without miserliness,
moist with great compassion,
free from aversion and envy,
greatly courageous and of great waves of energy —
so too the companion in practice:
free from attachment, non-dual,
without miserliness and endowed with diligence,
without anger and greatly brave,
devoted to the guru, greatly learned.
With the three fruits and so forth,
the body should first be properly purified by those.

Then, the mantrin should recite clearly
one hundred thousand times the Sumbha mantra:
Om sumbha ni sumbha hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Om gr̥hṇa hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Om
gr̥hṇāpaya gr̥hṇāpaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Om ānaya ho bhagavan vajravidyārāja

hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Then, the three-syllable mantra
is recited mentally by the master of practice.

In a dream, one sees the following:

the assembly-gathering of yoginīs.

The gift of their speech

is carried off by the daughters of the Enchantress.

For the benefit of sentient beings, boundlessly,

as the Vajradhāra himself acts —

a beautiful girl is found,

endowed with form, youth, and ornaments,

swollen with great desire,

swaying with graceful, pleasing movement,

firm of breast, blue-black and bold,

free of conceptual thought and greatly learned.

For such a great woman,

at the time when the lunar sign arises,

through the joining of union with her,

one should perform the rite of wisdom and skillful means.

At the time when taste arises,

one should proceed thus, step by step.

At that time, from the mouth-lotus,

it is to be taken for seven days.

In a very clear lotus vessel,

place the rakta, resembling a jewel.

For three days, with the mouth,

one should press clean the supreme lotus.

The rite of wisdom and skillful means

is then again to be undertaken by the yogin.

There, wine is to be drunk,

and powerful sālu rice is to be eaten;

or else the milk of a she-goat,

or else the power-food of space.

By practicing by night and by day,

one should examine the great method of extraction.

When the great vital essence arrives

and the young woman becomes intoxicated,

at that time it is to be taken with the mouth.
By means of the tube of the tongue and so forth,
it is to be placed in a faultless place,
in a lotus vessel.
On the eighth, or the fourteenth,
or on the tenth of the waning fortnight,
one slain by the tip of a spear or by a sword —
one of the five families, a single family.
Freedom from illness and the attainment of bliss,
beauty and the bloom of youth —
one born seven times or else three times —
may a companion of accomplishment bring these and come.
With varied offerings and oblations,
one should make worship with single-pointed focus.
The most excellent of its limbs are to be taken;
the lotus vessel is to be made for it.
With wisdom endowed with skillful means,
wine is to be drunk from that vessel.
Of great power, a small amount of oneself —
to accomplish attainment, it is to be eaten.
What has been extracted in the lotus vessel,
with some effort, is to be set aside.
The other woman is to be prepared with medicine,
and cooked by the power of the companion's sense faculty.
Goat's milk, sesame butter,
butter combined with sugar,
treacle and so forth in equal measure —
the power, it is recalled, becomes fivefold.
In the mouth, the three hot spices,
cardamom (śrī-cardamom), nāgakeśara,
nutmeg, cloves,
and camphor are to be made progressively larger.
In an exceedingly smooth and pure vessel,
fumigation is to be made with aloe wood and so forth.
With effort it is to be cooked in another vessel,
and set aside after fumigation has been done.
For seven days

powerful sālu rice is to be eaten.
By merely eating that,
one who has been unmoving will regain his former state.
That is to be taken in the lotus vessel;
the top and bottom are to be removed by the skilled one.
At dawn, a small amount is to be drunk,
and a small amount is to be placed in the vessel.
The arising of the two, wisdom and skillful means —
the luminous display that is gathered thereby —
the yogin is to make single-pointed.
This is the practice of the yogin's companion.

The fruits of emblic myrobalan (āmalaka) tree, belleric myrobalan (vibhītaka) tree,
tikarakuṭa, blue lotus,
milk with sour fermented whey —
cooking these with single-pointed focus,
one should cook in an iron vessel.
If one is not found, then in an earthen vessel.
With flowers of the pure family,
one should fumigate for seven days.
Then that essence medicine
is to be poured in gradually, increasing.
Clove, camphor, lāṭa,
musk, sandalwood, nutmeg,
nutmeg fruit, cardamom,
cloves, the three hot spices and their tastes,
combined with white sugar
and butter, are to be cooked.
With the fire brought to a gentle maturation,
it is to be cooked by the power of the companion's sense faculty.
Fumigation with aloe wood and so forth is to be done,
and it is to be placed in a stone vessel.
Each day, two measures of curd —
if melted, one should eat it;
if melted, four measures of curd,
then six measures of curd are always to be eaten.

The rite of the five nectars —
this great secret I have explained.
Furthermore, the medicine of the five limbs —
the skilled one should form it into pills.
Having made it into the size of an emblic fruit,
it is to be dried in the shade.
Having washed the cloth and the limbs,
the bindu is likewise to be made.
With effort it is to be placed in the mouth;
the maṇḍala of the feast is also to be made.
Pacifying, enriching, empowering,
wrathful, fierce and so forth —
by merely making the pills,
all will be accomplished without doubt.

This concludes the twelfth chapter, called "The Teaching of the Five Nectars,"
from the Glorious Great Seal Bindu.

In Oḍḍiyāna and other sacred places,
the yoginīs (ḍākinīs) are assembled.
In those places, one who utters words —
there exists a secret sound.
Listen with single-pointed mind:
I shall now explain this correctly.
Madana, wine, meat,
the gathering of ma and a-tsa is to be recalled.
Going, kheṭara, śrāva,
nirṃa, śuka, bone ornaments,
garlands at the neck — these are the ones who come.
Kuntu-ru engages the sense faculties.
Dudur is explained as one who is not fortunate.
Kalinjara — the fortunate one is to be sent within.
Diṇa-ḍireg is shown to be not a bird.
Skull-cup, lotus, bhañjana —
the four great fragrances are shown to be equal;
fragrant water and musk are to be recalled.
Semen is shown as camphor.
Great flesh, sālija-ru is recalled.
Bhahaka-ni is called water.

Feather is to be recalled as "limb."
Śaka is explained as "excellent."
Ho, it is said, is explained as "counted."
Jeghreka, the hunger of Laṃkara.
Dyungma-ghana, the wheel of the assembly.
Kapela-ma has become "two."
Nagaram is explained as "I give."
Bhataka-ni will become "you take."
Agani is shown as "abandoned."
Secret jewel is to be recalled.
Food is to be known as "smoke."
Pure flesh is to be recalled as "not food."
Purity is explained as mantra.
Impurity is spoken of as the sun.
Rapa — Brahmā, the renowned —
is shown as the body of the warrior class.
"Free from attachment, the lord" is what is shown.
"Attached" is to be recalled as "common people."
Caṇḍālī is explained as "bow."
Śvapaca-na is explained as "arrow."
Tsarma-kara, the wheel of existence.
Pukkasī is shown as "sword."
Ada-ka is explained as "empty."
Harika is explained as "flat ground."
Ratsa is explained as "ocean."
Minam is shown as "death."
"Expanded" is to be recalled as "pig."
Pig is shown as "brahmin."
Fish is shown as pālaśa.
Ra is shown as "daytime."
Sheep is to be known as "night."
Birds and the like — midday.
Golden flower is what is shown.
Incense is to be spoken of as "east, la."
Fragrance is explained as mālatī.
Butter lamp — śako-ni-kar is recalled.
Cloth is explained as kāśika.

Pleasure is shown as kāmala.
Forehead is to be spoken of as "water."
Eyebrow is to be recalled as "garland."
Eye is to be known as utpala.
Tooth is shown as adana.
Lip is to be known as palava.
Throat is shown as "flute."
The shoulder is shown as "smell."
The forearm is shown as "sprout."
The hand is known, it is said, as "lake-born."
The breast is spoken of as "glorious fruit."
The waist is to be known as "born of the mountain."
The navel is shown as madana.
The thigh is known as katampa.
Lotus — jagana is to be recalled.
The shin is to be spoken of as janabira.
The foot is to be recalled as acaśira.
The nail — the flower of a limb, supremely.
The nose — madaśabari.
The seat — śatakusum.
Capable — buni is to be recalled.
Incapable — the stalk of the lotus.
All, by name, is to be recalled as "rdza-mar."
A youth is known as "pool."
Blazing one — ocean is to be recalled.
An old one — great sea is to be recalled.
Experience — it becomes "not speaking."
Non-experience — to be recalled clearly.
"Not speaking" is to be spoken of as "deer of the mountain."
Song is explained as "habitual tendency."
Dance is to be recalled as "companion."
Sound is explained as "feigning propriety."
Touch is to be recalled as "lasso."
Taste is shown as "elegant."
Form is spoken of as "mountain."
Killing — "sound" is to be spoken of.
Life — the pigeon is to be recalled.

Village — the flower of the tāla palm.
Town is to be spoken of as "fruit."
Region is shown as "desire."
Desire is to be recalled as "life-force."
The unknowing — that one is to be recalled as "to tame."
The knowing — to be known as "to abandon."
Wild laughter is shown as "childlike."
Smoke is to be recalled as "blood."
Daytime is to be known as "youth."
Nighttime is well known as "young woman."
Twilight is to be known as "woman."
Midday is shown as "servant."
In the midst of the assembled gathering,
"yoginī" is always to be spoken.

This concludes the thirteenth chapter of the Glorious Great Seal Bindu, called
"The Chapter Showing the Secret Language in the Place Where the Yoginīs Are
Assembled."

Then, moreover, what is to be explained:
the defining marks of the limb-mudrās and so forth.
Whoever shows one finger —
that is an invitation called "the bedridden, not to be found."
Showing two fingers
is a good response: the growing tree.
Whoever makes the middle finger shown —
to that one, the ring finger is to be shown.
Whoever shows the little finger —
to that one, the tongue is to be shown.
Whoever shows the fist —
to that one, the trident is to be shown.
Whoever shows the topknot —
to that one, the tuft is to be shown.
Whoever shows the forehead —
to that one, the cheekbone is to be shown.
Whoever shows the armpit —
to that one, the ground is to be shown.
Whoever shows both hands —

to that one, the palm is to be shown.
Whoever shows the throat —
to that one, the belly is to be shown.
Whoever shows the upper lip —
to that one, the navel hollow is to be shown.
Whoever shows the teeth —
to that one, the tongue is to be shown.
Whoever shows the breasts —
to that one, the shoulder is to be shown.
Whoever shows the belly —
to that one, the navel is to be shown.
Whoever shows the secret place —
to that one, the liṅga is to be shown.
Whoever shows the thigh —
to that one, the buttocks are to be shown.
Whoever shows the foot —
to that one, the sole is to be shown.
Whoever shows the fingers —
to that one, the nails are to be shown.
Whoever shows a river —
to that one, the ocean is to be shown.
Whoever shows the sky —
to that one, the sun is to be shown.
Whoever shows the earth —
to that one, the sky is to be shown.
Whoever shows a furrowed brow —
to that one, the borderland is to be shown.
Whoever shows the teeth —
to that one, the lips are to be shown.
Whoever shows the throat —
to that one, the mouth is to be shown.
Whoever shows the forehead —
to that one, the back is to be shown.

All of these are the defining marks of the limb-mudrās and so forth of all the yoginīs.

This concludes the fourteenth chapter of the Glorious Great Seal Bindu, called "The Chapter on the Limb-Mudrās and So Forth of All the Yoginīs."

Then, moreover, what is to be explained: the defining marks of form and signs and so forth.

Whatever woman is reddish and slightly tawny, who emits the fragrance of a lotus, whose gaze is naturally peaceful, who follows after one who looks at her with longing, whose nails are red like a lotus, whose eyes possess the radiance of the sun — in her home there is a lotus, and she always performs the rites of offering. Know her as the chief of the lotus, belonging to the family of Padma, the lord of dance. Between her eyebrows there is a trident mark. Her body is of a pale bluish-white complexion, and in her home there is a vajra. She is to be worshipped with red tangku flowers. Know her as the mother of all who arise from the glorious Heruka family.

Whoever has a trident on her forehead, or in whom a śakti mark becomes manifest, with red eyes, a red face, and likewise red feet and hands, who always plays with owls, and likewise with dogs and domestic birds, and in whose home there is always someone who performs the worship of the vajra-mark — she has arisen from the glorious vajra family. She is a ḍākinī, the darling of heroes.

She who resembles blue clouds and always has a skull-cap on her head, who performs the wheel-rite in the home and always receives worship there — she is a ḍākinī who has arisen from the family of Vajravārāhī, proud in her power.

She whose eyes are lined with collyrium the color of the blue sky, whose teeth are prominent and sharp, who always delights in bathing, who does not speak much, who inquires after the vajra in the home and performs worship when it is nighttime — she is the glorious vajra ḍākinī who has arisen from the family of Vajravārāhī.

She who is radiant like refined gold, whose eyes are unmoving and who has much body-hair, on whose forehead a vajra becomes manifest, or in whose home it appears — always elegant like a queen, a supremely fortunate one who speaks truth, from whom the fragrance of mālīkā flowers arises, who performs the worship of the vajra in the home — she is a ḍākinī, a victor in gnosis, who has arisen from the Khaṇḍarohā family.

She who is exceedingly fond of meat, and —

whose eyes are dark as eye-collyrium or like the sky, who is slender and three-pointed in form, who always delights in wrathful deeds, who constantly goes to charnel grounds, who is fearless and without tenderness — she who performs worship in the home with beer and the like: without doubt she is a ḍākinī who has arisen from the family of glorious Heruka.

She who is the color of a cloud of serpents, whose left fang is bared — in whose home the effigy of an enemy is stroked and worshipped at all times: without doubt she is a ḍākinī who has arisen from the family of glorious Heruka.

The color, marks, and family-origins of all ḍākinīs have here been briefly explained. In full, they are found in the heart of gnosis.

This is the fifteenth chapter, entitled "The Form, Characteristics, and Family-Origins of the Ḍākinīs," from the glorious Bindu of Mahāmudrā.

Now listen, sovereign ruler of the maṇḍala — one who dwells as none other than the self, who bears the form of Hūṃ: the self itself is the substance of Hūṃ. From the form of Hūṃ, form arises, endowed with major and minor marks, dwelling upon a solar disc, equal in radiance to ten million suns. Through union together with you, she bears the form of a blue lotus: four faces, three eyes, eight arms, abiding with the right leg extended. She holds vajra and bell, sun and moon, bow and arrow fully drawn, a khaṭvāṅga staff and a skull-cup filled with great blood.

In the place of bliss, together with you I shall sport in delight most excellent. Then, from the primordial flavor, having emanated, the Vajra-Corpse-Raiser arises — dark of form, with four arms, holding bow and arrow drawn in her hands, a crocodile in the right and a skull-cup and khaṭvāṅga in the left, dwelling at the eastern gate.

Again, through the method of rubbing combined, from the second flavor, the Vajra-Net-Radiator emanates — naked and three-eyed, red of color, holding a fish in her hand, dwelling at the northern gate.

Again, from the third flavor, the Vajra-Tip-Radiator emanates — yellow of color, holding a lion in her hand, dwelling at the western gate.

Again, from the fourth flavor, the Vajra-Globe-Radiator emanates — white of color, holding a bird and a garuḍa in her hands, dwelling at the southern gate.

When these five flavors are obtained, the Vajra-Girdle-Woman emanates — holding a clay drum and a flute in her hands, she is the second form, dwelling

in the southeast corner.

Again, from the arising of the sixth, the Vajra-Finger-Radiator emanates — holding a lute and a great drum in her hands, dwelling in the southwest corner.

What is obtained from the perfectly seventh — the Vajra-Wild-Woman radiates — holding a clay drum and a cymbal in her hands, dwelling in the northwest corner.

When the eighth flavor is obtained, the Vajra-Sun-Radiator emanates — holding a tamara and a kara in her two hands always, she is emanated and dwells in the northeast corner, having conquered all māras.

Again, from rubbing and the method of rubbing, through the arising of the first joy, the Vajra-Excellent-Bliss radiates — holding in her hand a vessel of flavor, emanated and dwelling in the eastern corner of the dharmodaya.

The mudrā of the bhaga is placed at the crown of the head, the finger at the place of Brahmā's aperture. Again, from supreme joy, the Vajra-Lake-Woman radiates — holding a vessel of blood in her hand, dwelling in the southwest corner.

Again, from the arising of joy-free, the Vajra-Great-Elephant-Woman radiates — holding a vessel of semen in her hand, dwelling in the northwest corner. These are dark, yellow, and red in color, abiding with the left leg extended.

Again, from the perfectly accomplished method of rubbing —

From co-emergent joy arises —
co-emergent joy, great desire,
the great fire blazing forth intensely.

Together with my consort, there and then,
I transform utterly by intrinsic nature.

Without that substance, I do not transform;
I abide in the place of intrinsic nature.

My essential nature cannot be expressed —
it is hard to find even for all buddhas.

Yet if a perfectly and fully awakened buddha
should find it in conventional form,
the world-realms, innumerable,
are none other — pervaded by me.

Together with you, on the conventional level,
I sport as the cause for the arising of the elements.

If I were not to sport,
no buddhas whatsoever would arise.
That all this will pass, unshaken —
of that there is no doubt.
Abiding in the supreme place beyond intrinsic nature,
at that moment I speak nothing at all.

Rise up, Protector of supreme great bliss, excellently delighted!
O Excellent Vajra, joyously delighted — grant me joy!
O Protector, you and I are of the same taste;
bring me to birth through the taste of compassion.

O Protector! It is not the emptiness of annihilation;
O Protector, it is not the mere intrinsic nature of emptiness.
O Vajra-Lake-Woman — grant me joy!
Open the lotus and sport, sport!
A-la-la-la, a-la-la!
Ma-la-la-la — excellently delighted Protector!
O Vajra-Great-Elephant-Woman — grant me joy!

As you yourself have declared: if there is no self,
buddhas will not arise.
From the wisdom body, om̐ hūṃ — here,
you and I together arise.
With the wheel, the supreme wrathful body,
endowed with thirty-two limbs,
you and I in the place of bliss,
in the midst of the eight charnel grounds,
sport for the sake of the cause of birth —
the phase of the generation stage.

Dark in color with great radiance,
hair blazing like fire,
sixteen faces, three eyes each,
sixteen arms,
four modes of feet —
standing upon the four māras.
Excellently delighted Sovereign Woman — with you,
I, the Sovereign of the wisdom ḍākinīs,

whose form matches mine,
together with Terrifier and his consort,
in the center of the triangle, upon a solar seat,
with the foot raised in dance —
the Terrifying One, the Courageous One, the Beer-Drinker,
the Female Messenger of the Terrifier, the Powerful One,
Hayagrīvā-Woman and Horse-Ear-Woman,
Elephant-Nose-Woman and Belly-Woman,
Fire-Woman and River-Woman,
Moon-Woman and Sunlight-Woman,
Conch-Nose-Woman and Conch-Crown-Woman,
Conch-Navel-Woman and Great-Power-Woman,
Vulture-Head-Woman, the Hor-Woman,
Hor-Eye-Woman and Hor-Head-Woman,
Red-Eye-Woman, Red-Hair-Woman, Jewel-Woman,
Red-Owl-Woman, Black-Woman,
Rabbit-Doe-Woman, Deer-Doe-Woman, Goat-Doe-Woman —
those with four hands, of manifold forms,
three-eyed, with fearsome faces,
two hands holding bow and arrow drawn,
others holding knife and skull cup;
a vajra garland at the forehead,
limbs adorned with the five mudrās.
Such a great wheel —
this is my dwelling, together with you.
Whoever dwells in the twenty-eight stations
should call that to mind as a place of feast-gathering.
Vajra, bell, precious wheel,
sword, trident, arrow, sun,
moon, battle-axe, ḍamaru,
bow and mallet, kapāla,
the skin of a bhūta raised upward,
the skin of Yama's lord wrapped at the waist.
With one face and two hands —
and you too are of my color.
Adorned with all ornaments,
two hands holding bow and arrow drawn.

Then the completion stage:
the supreme sequential arising from the channels.
Each goddess, one at each tip —
their bliss, yours and mine,
through closing and opening,
the wind enters the fire within.
By the true faculty-wood,
the caṇḍālī blazes forth.
The form of the aggregate of conceptual thought —
the entire body is consumed.
By the true blazing of that fire —
the great bliss wheel melts.
Through that melting, from all the channels,
the supreme nectar (amṛta) drips.
Then the body recovers,
and the divine body is attained.

This is to be cultivated with one-pointed focus
through the yoga of habituation.
Even without an external mudrā,
bliss can arise —
mere gazing is sufficient.
Yet not all things are like all things:
when conceptual thought arises from without,
there will be no attainment (siddhi) in that.

Just as vessels in darkness
cannot be seen without a lamp,
and once they are seen by the lamp,
the lamp from outside may then be set aside —
the vessel is to be guarded with care,
and the lamp need not go on doing its work.
The defining characteristic of the lamp is here
the channel; the defining characteristic
of the channel is wisdom.
Skillful means is taught as bliss,
and bliss is to be recalled as gnosis.
The nature of bliss-gnosis,

whatever is found from the mother of wisdom —
that is the sovereignty of wisdom-gnosis.
That is the completion stage.

The very gnosis of great bliss
properly abides within the maṇḍala.
Divide great bliss into two:
conventional and ultimate.
From joy and so forth,
one should know the two blisses to be distinct.
The two true stages thereof —
listen with faith; I shall explain.

Appearance, touch, union,
and going — that is the fourth.
These are to be understood in sequence.

On the side of the generation stage,
through the view of the wisdom-mother,
the desire of both arises.
At that time joy arises,
of many kinds, moment by moment.
When, together with that,
contact is made through faithful touch,
then supreme joy,
stainless, arises.

Further, from the meeting of the two organs,
when union is made together with that,
at that time joy-apart-from-joy
arises brightly.

When from the two organs as kindling-sticks
the true fire blazes,
then co-emergent joy,
free of existence, arises.

Touching the breast, gazing —
desire: that is joy in the first place.
Thereafter its actual expansion,
when that is certain,

in that instant of expansion
supreme joy is performed.

When through that very suchness
the fire of desire blazes,
then the drops of that blazing
are the falling of joy-apart-from-joy.
The vajra and lotus engaged in play —
likewise that is joy-apart-from-joy.
That is the generation stage,
separate from the gnosis of the uta.

Now again, when the uta
proceeds from moments into oneness,
at that time the drop of the uta
becomes purified in the three aspects.
Then co-emergent with that,
vajra-like bliss is produced.
This is the side of the completion stage
of the Blessed Wisdom-Mother.
By the syllable "uta," bliss is indicated.
She of excellently pleased sovereignty — that is I.

There the four unions
I shall explain in full.
Desire, trembling, going,
and joy — these are the four.
That is the first union.
That is the meaning of joy.

Expansion, sufficiency, longing, arising,
and supreme joy — these are the four.
That is the second union.
That is the meaning of supreme joy.

Blazing, the drop's intoxication,
and joy-apart-from-joy — these are the four.
That is the third union.
That is the meaning of joy-apart-from-joy.

Uta, manner, and sleep:
co-emergent joy is the fourth.
That is the fourth union.
The distinctions of joy are sixteen.

These four are not other than this —
here the supreme meaning is as follows.
Desire is explained as longing,
stirred up by the glorious Wisdom-Mother.
That longing is set in motion
and performed by one's own mind.
The word "desire" means joy:
it is performed from seeing.

That very Blessed Wisdom-Mother,
when expanded by great passion,
is then expansion.

That is the supreme joy, the second.

At the time of expansion, outer and inner —
when they blaze exceedingly,
that very limb, in that instant,
will dissolve.

Now by the blazing drop
the name becomes made clear.
That is joy-apart-from-joy,
explained as the third.

Or else, that very Queen herself,
in the supreme aspect of great bliss —
in that moment, the drawing-in of Uta
is what brings separation from existence.
That is the fourth, the utterly supreme:
it is taught as co-emergent joy.

That drawing-in of Uta
is at the end of the three liberations of the drop,
and is the abode of co-emergence.
Through the distinctions of joy and so forth,
the sequence of co-emergence is to be understood.

From the crown of great bliss
down to the center of the brow wheel —
that extent is the abode of joy,
and is the characteristic of the singular drop.
From the brow wheel to the throat wheel —
that extent is supreme joy.
From the abode of the throat to the heart wheel —
that extent is joy-apart-from-joy.
Then, in sequence,
the successive abodes are fully explained.
From the navel wheel down to the root —
that extent is joy.
From the root down to the tip of the knot —
that extent is supreme joy.
From the abode of the knot to the jewel palace —
that extent is joy-apart-from-joy.
Within the tip of the vajra jewel
resides co-emergence: that is the ultimate.

This is the sixteenth chapter of the glorious Great Seal drop, entitled "The Maṇḍala, the Distinctions of Joy, the Characteristics of the Drop, and the Generation and Completion Stages."

The wisdom ḍākinī, the Blessed One —
I have arisen with a little doubt.
Manner and drop — their mode:
from where is gnosis to be known?

The Blessed One declared:
Manner abides in the place of the brow;
the drop resides in the place of the throat.
Understand that abundance resides in the place of the heart;
gnosis dwells in the place of the navel.
From conceptuality, non-conceptuality —
wherever one has gone and moves from there,
those rest in their own intrinsic nature.
This is well known as the abode of the navel.

When the nectar goes to its abode,
then one recalls what is called gnosis.

Nectar is known as the awakening mind (bodhicitta).

The four drops — manner and the rest —
their abodes are four,
and they proceed through the distinctions of joy.
At the brow: the drop of joy.
At the throat: what is recalled as the supreme.
At the heart: joy-apart-from-joy.
At the navel: the co-emergent.

Through the practice and application of all channels,
joy and the rest come to be found.

Above the brow there is a lotus,
and above that is the crown protrusion.
That is the great secret gnosis —
unknown even to the Victors.

Below the navel are three abodes;
above them is the root.
The three actual bodies below form the shape of the navel:
there the form of the vajra shines clearly.
Where the three bodies actually abide,
that is the supreme abode of the channels.
Two are Romā and Ḍzinma;
the third is non-conceptual.
That non-conceptuality is singular,
yet at the conventional level it becomes threefold.
It flows as a single continuum,
like a coiled serpent.

Through the divisions of body, speech, and mind,
the channels become three distinct kinds.
The tip of the vajra is the mind-vajra;
the substance of the three is speech.
The navel is known as body.
These are the definitive meaning of the three vajras.
At the heart is the mind-vajra;
the throat is the speech-vajra;
the glorious generative vajra —

I will make this fully clear.

Within it, at the center, is the life-force,
and likewise the proximate life-force.
From above the heart flows the life-sustaining wind;
from below the navel flows the nourishing wind.
When from the soles of the feet the nourishing wind —
— then at that time the life-sustaining wind
travels upward along its channel.
The nourishing wind settles definitely
at the site of the navel.
Again, when the life-sustaining wind
moves outward from the crown protrusion,
the nourishing wind
returns to its own place.
That is the life-sustaining wind —
it makes its dwelling at the site of the navel.

This is the chapter called "The Manner of the Drop of the Glorious Great Seal,
the Downpour, the Drop, the Site of Gnosis, and the Universal Movement of
the Channels" — the seventeenth chapter.

The Blessed One, I ask thee here:
what is the meditation of that one like?
Through the union of joined lotuses,
the defining mark of the seat of the lotuses is this.
By what sequence does the mind
come and go in such a way?

The Blessed One declared:
The question is genuinely secret —
no one whatsoever knows this.
Since you have made it clear,
listen — I will explain it correctly.

When supreme bliss arises, most pleasurable,
through the union of the practice of wisdom and skillful means,
at that time the path free from conceptual thought
causes the awakening mind (bodhicitta) to arise.

When the life-wind at the root of the navel
does not stir even for an instant,
whatever hollow lotus there is —
in an instant it rises upward.
At that time, at the center of the navel,
the mind becomes stable.
It will not then go downward.
Just as in an uncracked vessel
water abides without leaking,
so the mind certainly becomes stabilized.
That very instant one cultivates it in meditation.
Without doubt one becomes a buddha.

This is the chapter called "Stabilizing the Awakening Mind by Means of the Drop of the Glorious Great Seal, and Stabilizing Meditation" — the eighteenth chapter.

The characteristic of the gnosis of empowerment —
the Blessed One has spoken of that very meaning.

The Blessed One declared:
Listen — I will explain correctly
the meaning of the gnosis of empowerment.

A mudrā who has reached the age of sixteen,
beautiful of form and possessed of camphor from Śrī Laṅkā —
having made the mudrā naked,
one is to honor her with hands that delight.
Joining the lotus in union,
one is to desire repeatedly.
Gradually one is to arouse.
However the vital essence comes to flow,
when all of it has flowed forth,
it is to be restrained within the lotus.

The sovereign lady of supreme delight —
this is the supreme empowerment of the master.
Now this secret empowerment —
hear it with faith as I explain.

When the mind is present at the secret place,
that is known as the most secret.

The secret is the vital essence of the lotus —
it is secret within the knot.
One is to stabilize it at that site.
The mind is not the lotus of the sky.

The wisdom and the gnosis that are hard to find
in any tantra — I will explain them.
Wisdom is said to be nirvāṇa;
gnosis is to be understood as existence.
Cyclic existence is supreme joy;
nirvāṇa is to be understood as devoid of joy.
Alternatively, nirvāṇa is renowned
as the vessel of the jewel-lotus of the Buddha —
the mudrā of the bhaga of a woman.
That is to be understood as wisdom.
The vessel of gnosis is what is renowned.
The supreme abode of all bliss —
the vital essence is to be known as wisdom;
gnosis is to be understood as bliss.
The empowerment dissolves into light.
Gnosis is other than time.
That is the fourth cessation —
the characteristic of natural gnosis.

Light, power, cloud, and manner;
breath, the utpala flower, earth, and the mind;
the heart, the moon, the sun, darkness,
the supreme, sound, taste, and lightning —
these sixteen are to be understood:
the stainless drop of bliss.

From the brahma-opening down to the site of the throat —
that much comprises four drops.
At that site are the four joys,
endowed with the pair of tastes.

From the throat to the site of the heart —
again that much is four.
They are the four of the supreme joy,

endowed with the pair of tastes.

From the site of the heart to the jewel-source —
again that much is four.

They are the four of the joy-free joy,
endowed with the pair of tastes.

From the jewel-source upward to that site —
again that much is four.

They are the four of the co-emergent joy,
endowed with the pair of tastes.

The sixteen joys are the drops:
remember them well as portions of the moon.
Know them as the āli drops,
by the sequence of the four cakras.

Separated from the brahma-opening,
with taste — my own opening.
Those twelve are to be understood as the sun,
renowned as the kālī drops.

Half of twelve is the bliss-drop:
remember it as joy and supreme joy.
The three drops of the joy-free joy
are free from the three intrinsic natures.

And once again, all is selfhood itself.
I have explained the meaning of the four.
At the four sites are four empowerments:
know them as the lordly ones of pleasing delight.

By the sequence of cause and result,
in brief there are four:
the emanation, the Dharma, the enjoyment,
and the great bliss — the fourth.

These are the four bodies (kāyas),
to be understood as the ultimate.
Within the thirty-two-and-a-half channels are the sixteen āli drops.
The kālī drops are the others,
forever flowing down along the path.

The āli becomes the mind of gnosis.
The kālī arises from the mind of gnosis.
Great bliss alone
will divide into two at the conventional level.

Wisdom is of the nature of the moon;
skillful means is of the nature of the sun.
The moon is the cause, the āli is the result;
the āli is the cause, the moon is the result.
The sun is the cause, the kālī is the result;
the kālī is the cause, the sun is the result.

From the center of the sun the moon arises,
and in the form of the vital essence is the great bliss.
The kālī is the secret empowerment of bliss;
the āli is wisdom and gnosis,
and between those two is great bliss —
remember that this is its intrinsic nature.

Through embrace, touch, and so forth,
the master confers the empowerment.

This concludes the nineteenth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrā-tilaka: the chapter teaching the gnosis of empowerment, the cause and result of āli and kālī, the arising of the moon, the channels, the drops, and the joys.

Again, let the Blessed One speak on the conduct of the lord of yogins.

The Blessed One declared: Listen, you of good fortune, to the conduct of the lord of yogins.

In solitude, practicing the secret for a month — at the border of a territory or in a forest — all aims shall be accomplished. Recite this mantra constantly:

Hā svā ka ro ro ra ta taṃ va de ro dha na la tta ci ko ra dhā ta mre ga lā na jrā va oṃ.

Then the ḍākinīs (yoginīs) of the sky, having assembled, shall declare and bestow: "Son, take this girl. Perform the supreme conduct, and let it be done by you."

The girl is sixteen years old, she has sihla and camphor, her complexion resembles the blue utpala flower, she has the fragrance of sandalwood, she is adorned with graceful ornaments, and she is skilled in all activities. With effort,

enter into union with her in the secret form, and go in bliss together with her.

Once the aim has been obtained, each in their own form — in various guises — some practice with desire, some with a mind free from desire; some with a peaceful form, some with a mind endowed with pride; some are consumed by illness, some have a supremely blissful body; some make supplication, some are victorious like a great king; some are naked and impure, some are clean and spotlessly pure; some are satisfied with a little, some satisfy themselves greatly; some act with a sense of wonder, some with a mind free of shame; some sit in silence, some cry out with a great sound; some eat great masses of pungent food, some drink milk; some act sinfully, some act with great merit; some weep, some delight only in laughter; some play with ritual instruments, some dance alone.

Some are intoxicated with liquor, some follow the conduct of brahmins, some follow the conduct of skull-bearers, some serve as attendants of the fierce ones, some teach the Dharma, some listen to the Dharma, some perform illusions, some are free of illusion, some speak falsehood, some display the form of a child, some are old and advanced in years, some display the form of a prostitute, some engage in the supreme of desires, some attract through miserliness, some have a mind free of miserliness, some are branches of the animal realm, some are without consciousness, some are ineffable, and some display a form that is genuine and real. In this way the sovereign of yogins moves everywhere according to his own will.

This concludes the twentieth chapter, entitled "The Conduct of the Great Sovereign of Yogins," from the Śrī Mahāmudrātilaka.

The Blessed One, an ocean of wisdom — a doubt has arisen in me. Concerning the six wheels spoken of before: what are their seeds? By the mantra of whom are the five nectars eaten and consumed? And how is the essence of you and me certainly present?

For the protection of sentient beings, in the center of the gathered assembly-place, what is the nature of the wheel of the host? The Blessed One declared:

Listen, goddess of beautiful eyes. The seeds of the six wheels are: Kṣlīm, Mlīm, Plīm, Jlīm, Rlīm, Hlīm — place one of these in each center. Khaṃ, Raṃ, Śaṃ, Baṃ, Saṃ, Naṃ, Baṃ — these are the six seeds of the wheel of wind. Blīm, Klīm, Jlīm, the fire-wheel — the wise one should place these arranged in a triangle. The consonants Ka, Kha, Ga, Gha, Ņa; Ca, Cha, Ja, Jha, Ña; Ṭa, Ṭha,

Ḍa, Ḍha, Ṇa; Ta, Tha, Da, Dha, Na; Pa, Pha, Ba, Bha, Ma; Ya, Ra, La, Va; Śa, Ṣa, Sa — place these seeds, doubled, upon the petals of the emanation wheel. Trāṃ, Hrīṃ, Ūṃ, Khaṃ, and Lāṃ, Māṃ, Pāṃ, Tāṃ — these are the eight seeds of the Dharma wheel. A, Ā; I, Ī; U, Ū; Ṛ, Ṝ; Ḍ, Ḍ̄; E, Ai; O, Au; Aṃ, Āḥ — this enjoyment wheel of eighty-two characters should be written in leftward rotation. These doubled are the seeds of the great-bliss wheel.

The flat portion of earth, equal and level, should be anointed with liquor and the like. The wise one should honor the ground with supreme sandalwood and saffron, with the finest and most varied flowers, and with various excellent offerings.

A girl of divine form, captivating the mind, twenty years of age, of steady composure — in the place where the king of mantras has been gathered, first introduce her there. Through the union of supreme joy, with one-pointed mind, perform the approach practice. When the approach rite is complete, thereafter sprinkle and scatter upon the ground. In the same way, the bindu of the student is applied to the girl. Send the torma — filled with great meat and the like — in the four directions. Strive to make the feast offering as best one can; if it is lacking, strive nonetheless. At the time when the mantra is gathered, with effort honor the guru. If the guru is pleased, the king of mantras will be attained without doubt. If it is not so, there will be fault and the mantra will not be attained.

Encircled by a vajra garland, draw a lotus with eight petals. In the center place the seed syllable Kṣa, possessed of the nature of Vajrasattva. Joining the vowels and consonants together, gather the seven sages. First draw Vairocana — the fifth of the fifth, the fourth of the aspirates, and possessing the second of the sixteenfold; the first of the first, adorned below by fire; possessing the thirteenth vowel — this is the weapon of all delusion. The fourth of the fourth, possessing the eleventh vowel, the first of the aspirates, and the fourth of the semi-vowels; then the seed of fire, the third of the second —

the first of the semi-vowels, and the fourth of the semi-vowels, possessed of the third vowel — this destroys the essence of all things. The third of the second, then the first of the eighth, possessed of the second vowel — this is the abode of the supreme syllable. The first of the third, adorned below by that same one — or else write that one alone. The fourth of the sibilants, possessed of the second vowel, bearing the nature of Vajrasattva. The third of the sibilants, the fifth of the fifth, the fourth of the sibilants, adorned by the second

vowel. The first of the first, the third of the semi-vowels, the first of the fifth, adorned by the second vowel. The third of the first, adorned by the twentieth — possessed of the third vowel: the great vast form of the wrathful one. The third of the sibilants, the fifth of the fourth — place that one below; adorned by the third vowel: this is the act of all the gods. The fourth of the fifth, adorned by the second vowel. The first of the eighth — this is the father of all and everything. The fourth of the sibilants, adorned by the sixth vowel, bearing the lunar digit and bindu — this is the supreme syllable, the lord of mind. Write that one as well. Then the second of the fifth, the first of the third, the third of the sibilants, joined with the fourth of the semi-vowels, adorned by the second vowel. The eighth of the class of Ya, possessed of the second vowel — this is the supreme accomplisher of all aims: the king of mantras of my own essence. The lord who is master of form, the fourth of the semi-vowels, the third of the second, adorned below by fire. The first of the fourth, possessed of the eleventh vowel; the third of the second, adorned by the thirteenth vowel. The third of the first, adorned below by fire; the fourth of the sibilants, adorned below by the mountain syllable, possessed of the fourth vowel — this brings all sentient beings under one's power. Or else write that same one. Likewise the second of the fifth and the first of the third — the supreme mantra of the close essence. First comes Vairocana, then the third of the sibilants possessed of the fifth vowel — this causes the minds of the gods to be filled with delusion. Then the seed of fire, then the first of the fourth, the third of the sibilants, then the twenty-fifth, then write the seed of wind, possessed of the eleventh vowel — this supremely crushes the mudrās of others. The first of the sibilants, joined with the fourth of the semi-vowels, then the seed of the sun, adorned by the third vowel. The fourth of the sibilants, possessed of the sixth vowel, adorned by the lunar digit and bindu — or else write that same one: this destroys the mantras of others. The second of the fifth, then the first of the third, the third of the sibilants, joined with the fourth of the semi-vowels, possessed of the second vowel — this eliminates all suffering. The eighth of the class of Ya, possessed of the second vowel — this accomplishes all attainments: the king of mantras of your own essence. First the lord of the gods, then the first of the first, possessed below of the earth syllable, adorned by the fourth vowel, adorned by the lunar digit and bindu — the doer of all and everything. The fourth of the semi-vowels, possessed below of the earth syllable, adorned by the fourth vowel, adorned by the lunar digit and bindu. The third of the second, possessed below of the earth syllable, adorned by the fourth vowel, adorned by the lunar digit and bindu. The second of the fifth,

possessed of the first of the Yi — and adorned at the end with Svāhā: this is your intimate essence. That is the great secret of mantra; it is not given to just anyone. Likewise this instruction, O goddess, is not given to just anyone. Among ten million hundreds of thousands, there is but one who is a vessel for instruction. The mantra or instruction is to be examined, and only then given. Even over a hundred million aeons, without doing so it will not be accomplished. This instruction is obtained from the mouth of the guru by the greatly pleased and powerful one. It is never truly obtained from treatises or scriptural transmissions. For the sake of the instruction, one should not petition the supreme guru again and again. If the guru is pleased, he will give that instruction of its own accord. Just as when a daughter has come of age and does not petition her father, the father himself, knowing, thinks: "Now is the time to give my daughter in marriage."

The five nectars are to be consumed by means of the king of mantras Trāṃ Hrīḥ Khaṃ. The seeds of earth, water, fire, and wind are to be eaten.

This is the twenty-first chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrā-tilaka, entitled "The Chapter on the Seeds of the Six Cakras, the Drinking of Mantra, the Eating of the Five Nectars, and the Conduct."

In order to protect against spirits, listen now — I shall explain the torma. In a charnel ground, or on a riverbank, at the edge of a village, under a solitary tree, or in an empty house, the torma is to be offered with effort. All the yoginīs who are present — along with their retinues — such as the feminine form of Brahmā, the Fierce Goddess, the Great Goddess of Sovereignty (Mahāśvarī), the Pervasive Goddess (Viṣṇudevī), the Sow-Goddess (Vārāhī), the Lion-Headed Goddess (Narasimhī), the goddess equal to Indra (Indrāṇī), the Fire Goddess, the Water Goddess, the Wind Goddess, the Maiden, the Yakṣiṇī, the Garuḍī, the Shape-Shifter, the Elephant Goddess, the Goddess of Death (Yamī), the Wealth-Giving Goddess, the Sun Goddess, the Fierce One — all such yoginīs and ḍākinīs, together with their retinues, are to be summoned here by the yogin with this mudrā:

Form the vajra fist with both hands, cross them back to back, thread the little fingers into a chain, extend the index fingers upright, and draw both right and left hands inward slightly.

All yoginīs, all ḍākinīs, spirits, hungry ghosts, flesh-eaters, the greatly wrathful ones, and those who cause forgetfulness — come here, come here! Accept this torma adorned with fish and meat and great blood and various foods and

drink, flowers, incense, lamps, perfume, the five nectars, beer, victory banners, pennants, parasols, and yak-tail fans. Uphold this pledge! Be a companion in all my purposes! For the sake of protecting those who have devotion to this tantra — partake, drink, and revel! Hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā!

Place the mudrā of the bhaga at the crown of the head. With this mudrā offer the torma. Press down with the foot and gaze upward. Cry out the sound Ha Ha! And visualize oneself as Heruka, endowed with ornaments of bone. Even if asuras resembling Indra should appear before you, do not be afraid of them — let alone what need is there to speak of others?

This is the twenty-second chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrā-tilaka, entitled "The Chapter on the Activity of the Torma."

Listen now to the rite of the gaṇacakra, O fair-eyed goddess! In that place of supreme secret delight, turn the wheel fully.

All are of one pledge, all are free of conceptual thought, all have abandoned miserliness and pride, all are free from attachment and aversion, devoted to the guru and endowed with meditative concentration, without envy and with single-pointed focus — in such joy is the gaṇacakra to be turned.

The learned one must make effort and enter in. If it is otherwise, there will be fault, and the wheel will not be accomplished. The wisdom-consort who is on a par with skillful means must be beyond twenty-five years of age. Each one possessing one unit of skillful means and one unit of wisdom — for all of them, a single one is not beautiful.

First, with mind-captivating delight, draw the flower maṇḍala. There, the various offerings are to be performed excellently with single-pointed focus. With all things, the guru is to be worshipped with faith. Offer also to the assembly with effort, and view equanimity with the mind. Just as the guru holds the mudrā, so too does the assembly.

What has a trident or has been slain with a sword is to be taken at midnight. With the fire-offering of various offerings, worship, and then make the guru's seat. In the center, oneself as Heruka, endowed with the great seal — that one is indicated as the guru, and the excellent, joyful, sovereign lady is oneself.

In the center of the gaṇacakra wheel, spittle and the like must not be discarded. Ordinary words must not be spoken, and the legs and so forth must not be stretched out. The sign language of the mudrās and the secret speech — one must act with effort in these.

Without the command, dance and song must never be performed by the assembly.

A vessel bearing the mark of a single piece is to be placed before the guru, or else one that is in three pieces, filled with divine wine. With the fire-offering of various offerings, that vessel is to be worshipped. The other vessel at the gaṇacakra wheel is adorned with flower ornaments.

Endowed with various foods, the great torma first — however much joy there is, it is not without purpose; drink more and more. Again and again make prostrations, and holding the mudrā, drink. Then all foods whatsoever, having been purified, are to be consumed.

The navel, the white moon-holder, and the supreme Hayagrīva — with HŪṂ, the excellent white vajra is employed, with AḤ it is fully comprehended, and with OM's light it blazes; having been consecrated through blessing, consume it explicitly.

On one's own tongue, in the center of the lotus petals, place the white vajra arisen from HŪṂ. With that wheel, fully satisfy all — inner and outer — oneself completely. By the fourfold division of the wheels, purify all the wheels without remainder.

On the hero's tongue the hero, and the hero of heroes in the center. On the hero's mouth the hero — at the time of the offering, perform the offering. In the center between the two navels is the supreme place of all heroes, the supreme aim of the heroes. If one does not know all of that hero, one will never attain the gaṇacakra wheel.

Whatever it may be — in this sequence, the outer and inner activity. If one acts in this way, one attains siddhi, and the ḍākinīs likewise gather together.

If a yoginī of another lineage should come for the purpose of examination, a wise one must never for a moment harbor doubt toward her. Do not speak ordinary words; invite her by mudrā gesture. Whatever the guru there speaks and does — or the karma-vajra may likewise perform all the necessary acts. Just as the vajrasattva (Skt. vajrasattva) takes pleasure, so does the karma-vajra.

If a yoginī of various forms comes again and again, do not for a moment be afraid. Proceed in the form of a hero. When one who is restrained acts contrary to restraint, that one is to be understood as one who has fallen to a downfall. If genuine joy arises, dance for the sake of liberation. Yet dance in the manner of

the vajra-foot dance, however the yoginī is pleased.

To one's mother, or younger sister, or daughter-in-law, or bride — with the rite of wisdom and skillful means, make effort and offer to them. By worshipping them, whatever siddhi one has in mind — taking the remaining tormas, send it to the great hermitage.

If a yoginī there should reveal such a view — their characteristics are as follows:

The wise one should strive to know this. Whoever has a face whose maṇḍala appears completely round, with a beard ever present, with long body hair and long eyebrows, with fine and pure and peaceful garments, who is steady, who speaks truthfully, and who always delights in the sacred Dharma — remember her as the sister of the hero. The lotus mudrā is to be given. Likewise, the tortoise mudrā. The leather-vessel libation mudrā is to be understood as the reply. On the tenth day of the fortnight, she comes to one's home to ask about the lotus.

These are the very characteristics of the lāmā woman. With lips hanging down and eyes long in their line, with eyes that are red and yellowish, wealthy, fortunate, and endowed with good qualities, appearing yellowish, like a yellow grain, neither very tall nor short, delighting in various colored garments, with three marks on the forehead, glancing upward with ill-omened eyes, wild and joyful, pressing firmly upon the path as she stands, always delighting in tales of those who have died in battle — when one sees such a supremely proud one, display the three-pointed mudrā. With the right foot drawn up, display also the dance itself. Turning the left away completely is said to be the reply mudrā.

The tenth and the eighteenth are taught to be her auspicious times. In her home, a three-pointed lance is to be drawn and always worshipped. These are the characteristics of the lāmā, sovereign of the world.

The one whose mother's complexion is of pure dyed coloring, dwelling and appearing in a nook, with reddish-yellow coloring and red hands in the same way, with eyes appearing greenish-yellow, with hair likewise curling, with silk bound upon the head, clearly present on the forehead in the form of a bow as its very support, likewise with a long neck and long nose, always delighting in red garments, wild and singing songs, sometimes angry, with a wavering mind, delighting in disputes — upon seeing such a supremely proud one, display the śaktī mudrā. With the second effort, display the bell mudrā.

Turning toward the left is said to be the reply mudrā.

Short, with fat limbs, always delighting in yellow garments, with garments hanging from the shoulders — upon seeing such a woman, display the wheel mudrā. With effort, display also the second, the conch mudrā. Turning completely away from the left is said to be the reply mudrā. The fourteenth is her auspicious time. In her home is something resembling a vajra. These are the characteristics of the glorious lāmā Heruka.

With body hair covering the entire body, with eyes dark and yellowish, fat with a frightful appearance, with a large and growing face and a wide mouth, with lips hanging down and a dark complexion, with round eyes and a damaged nose, always skilled in song and dance, with a cloud-like figure and large thighs — upon seeing such a supremely proud one, display the song mudrā. With effort, display also the second, the lance mudrā. Turning completely away from the left is said to be the reply mudrā. The eleventh day of the lunar count is her auspicious time. In her home she asks about fangs.

These are the characteristics of the lāmā Vajravārāhī. At night, on the path, one should strive and know this. Do not come to all of them with fear. Please them with the mudrās. Having pleased them, they grant the siddhi one has in mind.

This is the twenty-third chapter, entitled "The Rite of the Feast Circle and the Characteristics of the Limbs of the Ḍākinīs," from the glorious Bindu of Mahāmudrā.

Then, moreover, what is to be further explained:

There the karma is supreme indeed.

Whoever merely relies upon it
swiftly enters into siddhi.

The limbs are exceedingly soft and fragrant,
the dust becomes sweet-smelling,
and she is greatly modest and speaks truthfully.

For a long time her eyes do not blink.

She is without anger and has great compassion.

She speaks gently even for a moment.

She is to be sought with effort
in seven births or else in three.

One who has merit in mind

will find her in hand.

Having caused that to be consumed,
at her heart-center, the rocanā substance —
with a one-pointed mind,
reciting the Heruka mantra seven times,
one strives to make the bindu.
Immediately it will rise upward
and travel billions of leagues.

Merely by eating it
one becomes possessed of gnosis throughout the three realms.
One travels fifty billion leagues
by day and by night, entirely.
One also attains a divine body
and dwells for a thousand aeons.
One's power becomes equal to that of Śakra (Indra).
By merely beholding a woman,
just as butter melts before fire —

This is the twenty-fourth chapter, entitled "The Rite of Karma," from the
glorious Bindu of Mahāmudrā.

The Blessed One, sovereign king of primordial wisdom —
a doubt has arisen in me.
For a mantra-practitioner to accomplish mantras,
how should that recitation be?

The Blessed One declared:
Yogins should recite and meditate.
Listen, goddess, Gomatī.
Having equalized the life-wind and the effort-wind,
one is to consume the life-wind and the effort-wind.
Having stopped the life-wind and the effort-wind,
one gazes upon the life-wind and the effort-wind.
From the union of joined lotuses,
wisdom and method are to be practiced.
From the sky of the two navels,
unseparated as the tip of a needle,
the syllables bearing the light of crystal —

the garland of vowels is to be recalled.
Each syllable, with the mind,
is to be recited continuously without interruption.
Within the center of the cakras,
having caused it to turn, one draws it straight.

With the soft sound of ha ha,
the throat and palate remaining unmoved,
let the inner soft touch
be established in the heart-center alone.
Wisdom, known as the form of the fierce one (caṇḍālī),
the one who grants bliss free of phenomenal forms,
the one who generates touch without the touch-faculty —
together with such wisdom,
in the vajra-seated posture, with the mind,
let the mind be made free of agitation.

In the manner of the bindu, also free from the manner of the drop,
in the manner of the bindu also as suchness,
in the manner of the bindu and the drop also within:
the yogin should direct the mind there.
Direct the mind inward also in the manner of the drop.
Direct the mind also inward in the manner.
Meditate that the manner flows into the bindu,
and the bindu too goes into emptiness.
Emptiness is shown as intrinsic nature.
Free from the three, it is the supreme unborn.

By such a rite as this,
by the method of this rite,
whoever recites with one-pointed focus —
that one obtains the great siddhi,
without doubt within a single month.

This is the twenty-fifth chapter, entitled "The Natural Recitation," from the
glorious Bindu of Mahāmudrā.

The Blessed One, heroic, sovereign lord of heroes —
you previously declared the time.
Omniscient, supreme sovereign lord —

please explain the meaning of that.

As for the meaning of that time,

listen, goddess, far-seeing one.

Time was explained as the drop.

The meaning of the connection among those —
make the four connections fourfold.

One limb is abandoned.

That which is hard to find even by the Victors —
its arising I shall explain.

With regard to the life-staff of the support,
the connection is there taught.

The life-staff abides in the center,
supremely subtle, utterly fine,
possessing thirty-two knots.

It is neither outer nor inner.

Connect it at the place of the knots.

That is the meaning of the drops.

The connection of the drop is not within.

Within, that one is without conceptual thought. Within the knots, right and left, the Rasanā and Lalanā abide. Between every two knots there is one, and the thirty-two knots call to mind sixteen. The great bliss wheel abides at the throat, and from there upward to the navel is what lies above. The cord of twelve finger-breadths is alone without a knot. Below that, what bears the knots extends down to the wind wheel. From the crown down to the throat — that span constitutes four connections. From below the throat to the place of the heart — another such span is four. From the place of the heart to the navel — yet another four as well. From the navel to the jewel-throat — another four again. These are taught as the four connections.

Even the rain is free from joy. Desire, dust, trembling, and power; movement and nectar as well; joy and the lotus, just so — these are the first four connections.

Swelling, dust, the knot, and intoxication; the element, night, supreme bliss, and taste — these are the second connection.

Blazing, pacifying, the drop abiding, intoxication, and the lower, just so; free from joy, drawing joy in — these are the third connection.

Utpalā, the winged, the proprietary wind, sleep and fire, just so; co-emergent joy, the unborn — these are the fourth connection.

At just the point of passing to the jewel-throat, that is to be understood as the full moon. The connection where joy is present is to be known as having arisen. The fifteenth is the cause of the element. At the sixteenth, one does not conceptualize, because there is no arising or ceasing — and so there is no connection there.

Now listen, one-pointedly, to the connection of even the rain with the arisen form. The sixteen, just as the sun — wherever the two join, that is called the unborn aspect. That itself is essential nature, intrinsic nature. The sixteen, just as the sun, constitute the continuum of transformation. That is the father of all elements, possessing skillful means and wisdom in equal measure. The sixteen is wisdom; the sun is taught as the skillful means. Beyond sixteen, understand it to be the supreme mindfulness of the sun. The intrinsic nature abiding between those two is hard to find through the path of speech. Such is the meaning of time — I have explained it truly. Other than this, the supreme secret has no fair face, no truth to it. Conceal it with diligence; do not bestow it even upon the body.

This concludes the twenty-sixth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrāṭilaka, entitled "The Meaning of the Intrinsic Nature of the Meaning of Time."

That which was formerly concealed by the mantra, now made clear — listen, five goddesses, I shall explain it. It is for those of faith to know, and it is never for those without faith.

Hā svā ṭha hūṃ hūṃ ya bhā nni sa gni pā la kā hā mas ha ṭṭhā ṭṭhā ya ja bi ya ja ra śvadhe kro hā ma oṃ.

This mantra of the great secret accomplishes every aim and purpose.

Ṭpha hrīṃ hrīṃ gri jo te jrab oṃ.

This great heart-mantra of the near essence places all and everything under one's power.

Hā svā ṭpha hūṃ hūṃ ri śva ye mas ta ra gu oṃ.

The sovereign mantra of your essence is endowed with countless qualities. For the purpose of accomplishing the gnosis of the mantra-holder, the secret

mantra has been made clear.

Hā svā ṭpha jliṃ bliṃ kliṃ oṃ.

This near essence of yours is hard to find even by the buddhas. Through its mantra I have brought countless ones under power.

This concludes the twenty-seventh chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrāṭilaka, entitled "The Revelation of the Concealed Mantras."

Then, having embraced her in pledge and with pleasing words, the glorious joyous Lady of Sovereignty, the Blessed One, spoke thus:

O Blessed One, you who are the gnosis-ḍākinī,
destroyer of the darkness of ignorance —
from among all the secrets you have declared,
the Great Seal you have not yet spoken.

How is the Great Seal? Sovereign of Victors, declare it truly.

The Blessed One then spoke: The supreme form of perfect bliss — hear this, goddess: the Great Seal, the great secret, inexpressible, inexhaustible, unborn; all of it is form, yet free of form; formless, yet the supreme essence of form; free of coarse, subtle, and all such distinctions; its intrinsic nature is immeasurable. It is the light of perfect, stainless aspect, dwelling nowhere at all; it neither rises nor sets, yet it is supremely that which ever rises. It is free of time and occasion, yet it is that which produces arising and cessation.

For yoginīs it is not difficult to find; for one who is merely a yogin it is difficult to find. It is found through the supreme method, and without the supreme method it is never found at all. O great hero, Blessed One — declare the method for this.

The Blessed One spoke: Through the practice of engaging with the root channels, it is found from the mouth of the master. When one abides in the sphere where the channel-wheel is ever present, there is neither wind nor sleep. The right and left portions — rotate them in the sphere with great care. By their absorption into the interior, the supreme bliss arises from that. And from within that bliss, the Great Seal is found without doubt.

In the sphere, in the center, is the abiding place of the channels — supremely subtle, the subtlest of the subtle, perfect and supreme. In the abiding place of the channels, within the abiding place of the channels — that much alone is the definite pervasion.

The intrinsic nature of the Great Seal, O great goddess, is you yourself. My own luminosity — truly, that is you. It exists both outwardly and inwardly. One who does not know the Great Seal, even if they be a buddha, is not a yogin. This bindu (Skt. bindu) of the Great Seal — one who does not know it as stainless is not one.

Even if a yogin or yoginī's stream of being has the certain understanding of a hundred thousand yogas, nonetheless the supreme fruit will never arise from that alone. If one knows all phenomena, all dharmas, perfectly, that one is assuredly a buddha. If one knows the Great Seal perfectly, that one becomes the glorious Vajrasattva (Skt. Vajrasattva). That one's intrinsic wisdom is the defining characteristic of the Great Seal.

Upon hearing these words, the Blessed Lady, surrounded by seventy-two trillion ḍākinīs, circumambulated three times, then prostrated and made offering with warm blood. All the ḍākinīs, having heard the tantra of the bindu of the Great Seal from the Blessed One, were filled with joy and delight and fell silent.

Then, embracing him again in pledge, she spoke thus: Blessed One, lord of yoginīs — a slight doubt has arisen in me. That which the maṇḍala ritual describes as the root tantra — the location of self and other — I had not previously understood.

The Blessed One spoke: The location of my own self and the other likewise — hear, I shall explain it correctly. The location of the other is declared to be the bhaga (Skt. bhaga). The location of my own self is the essence. The location of the other is outside the door; the location of my own self is the maṇḍala. Or alternatively, the location of the other is the ordinary union, and the location of the self is the proximate union. The ordinary union is designated as the celestial realm; similarly, the union of the human domain. The proximate union is the subterranean; the celestial realm is the Dharma-lotus of the heart. The proximate union is the summit of Mount Meru; the human domain is the very navel of the navel. The subterranean is the essence of the emanation; the summit of Mount Meru is the secret nostril.

In this way, the other — the great secret — I have not elsewhere described it to be other. One must guard this diligently; it is to be given to no one. It is to be taught to a sovereign yoginī, a mistress of yoginīs. Or else this great bodhisattva — having examined it well, it is to be elucidated.

This concludes the primary, primary accomplishment of the glorious great Heruka.

This concludes Chapter Twenty-Eight, entitled "The Marvellous Among the Marvellous," sovereign lord of the tantra-king of the Great Mahāmudrā Bindu Tantra of the Great Yoginī — the subsequent tantra of the most secret beyond even the supreme secret of all the Tathāgatas — difficult to find even by omniscience.

This completes the work entitled "Sovereign Lord of the Tantra-King of the Great Mahāmudrā Bindu Tantra of the Great Yoginī."

Translated and established by the Indian master, the great lord of yoga, the glorious Prajñā Guhyavadana, in the presence of Kama Chökyi Yeshe and Phyugtshams Drakbom Arhat, who requested it with faith and reverence.

Translator's Notes

- The title's Sanskrit is given in the text in transliterated Tibetan and has been restored in the heading. The term "bindu" (Tibetan: thig le) is retained in the title rendering as it is a technical tantric term; in the body it is rendered contextually as "bindu" or "drop."

The figure "Bhaṅgamā" (Tibetan: bzang mo / byang mo) in the line "O Bhaṅgamā — she is a beast of the field" is a significant crux. The Tibetan reads "bzang mo de ru byol song yin," meaning "the fair one is there an animal (byol song = tiryak)." This appears to be a paradoxical or antinomian statement characteristic of yoginī tantra: what appears noble or fair is, at the ultimate level, identified with an animal-realm being, or conversely, the questioner "Bzangmo" is being addressed and told that relative appearances (such as gods like Śiva) are in fact no better than animals. The translation renders it as best it can given the compressed verse, but this passage may require traditional commentary for full resolution.

The phrase "five hundred thousand" (五百万遍, *gohyaku manben*) refers to the five hundred thousand verses that are said to constitute the full Hevajra tantra cycle in its complete form, a standard claim in Indian tantric literature.

- The passage is from a Vajrayāna tantra describing empowerment theory and the guru-student relationship in the context of highest yoga tantra practice. Several points deserve comment.

The enumeration of empowerments into eleven, twelve, thirteen, and fourteen sub-divisions correlates with the bodhisattva grounds: each empowerment authorizes mastery over a particular ground, making the "fourteenth" the result-ground of buddhahood. This is a standard Anuttarayoga structural schema.

The phrase rendered "the emanation king" refers to the human guru understood as a royal emanation body, a *nirṃaṇakāya* king, which is a standard tantric way of presenting the guru's nature.

The final section contains explicit sexual yoga terminology, which is standard in highest yoga tantra literature. "The jewel" refers to the male organ, "the arrow" is the vajra implement used ritually, and the "bliss of the maiden" refers to the experience of non-conceptual

bliss-emptiness inseparable wisdom arising through the practices described. "Let down into the student's mouth" is understood in the commentarial tradition as the transmission of the bodhicitta drop, the bindu. The text is presented here as translated faithfully from the Tibetan without euphemism, as it belongs to a canonical tantric context.

The identity of the specific tantra is not determinable from this passage alone, though the structural scheme of four empowerments with numerical sub-divisions is consistent with texts in the Cakrasaṃvara or related mother-tantra cycles.

- The passage is from the Śrī Mahāmudrātilaka, a Vajrayāna tantric text. The verse and prose sections employ heavily coded, polysemous language characteristic of the twilight language (Skt. sandhyābhāṣā) genre. The erotic and physiological imagery is simultaneously doctrinal and somatic, and the translation renders both registers as the tradition intends without collapsing either.

The phrase "thirteen sovereigns do not know it" likely refers to the thirteen bhūmis (grounds) in certain Vajrayāna enumerations, implying that even the most advanced stages of the path do not fully comprehend this reality; this is a significant exegetical point.

The channel names in the final section present difficulties: the six channel-names of the wind wheel are rendered as best as the Tibetan permits, but some names (e.g. "great revolver," "greatly fearsome") may be conventional tantric epithets with specific identifications in the commentarial tradition not recoverable from the root text alone. The term "iḍā" for "ཀླུ་མཚལ་" follows standard Tibetan-Sanskrit channel equivalences; "rasanā" for "རྩ་མཚལ་" is standard.

- The long catalogue of channel-goddess names in this passage is a technical enumeration unique to this tantra. Many of the names are obscure epithets or descriptive compounds with no established commentarial gloss available; the renderings given are literal translations of the Tibetan components and should be understood as provisional. The term "ལྷ་མཚལ་" appears repeatedly and its precise referent in this context — possibly a class of swift or minor channels — is uncertain; it has been rendered consistently as "swift" based on context and the related sense of quickness or agility the root can carry.

The phrase "ཀླུ་མཚལ་ལྷ་མཚལ་" rendered as "the skull" refers to the crown cakra, which in tantric anatomy is associated with the cranium and is the seat of the great bliss wheel — this is standard in the Anuttarayoga Tantra physiological schema.

The final line is incomplete as given; the translation breaks off accordingly.

- The terms "bolla" and "kakola" are technical Sanskrit loanwords preserved in Tibetan transliteration, referring to specific substances or channels in the tantric physiological system; their precise referents vary across commentarial traditions and are left untranslated here as proper technical terms.

The phrase rendered "wisdom body free from consciousness and free from self" describes the primordial ground-state before birth; the Tibetan jñānakāya here is distinct from the standard trikāya usage and refers to the innate primordial wisdom dimension.

The "seventh touch" is a technical tantric term for a specific category in a classification of tactile experience; the numbering system varies by tradition and is not further glossed here to avoid imposing a particular commentary.

The "emptiness body" rendering of śūnyatākāya is contextually derived; the Tibetan reads "stong sku," which in this tantric context designates the luminous empty nature rather than the standard trikāya category.

- The phrase rendered "others who have not died" is a literal rendering of a grammatically and doctrinally unusual construction. It may be a rhetorical flourish addressing the assembly

broadly, contrasting those with residual afflictions. The doctrinal import seems to be that even buddhas and bodhisattvas do not teach this openly.

"Āli and Kāli" are technical tantric terms referring to the vowels and consonants of the Sanskrit alphabet as mantra-elements, and more esoterically to the left and right nāḍīs or to lunar and solar drops. No standard Sanskrit reconstruction is given in the text; the terms are kept as is per tantric convention.

"Thirty-three excellent marks" departs from the standard "eighty minor marks" formula; this appears to be a tantric enumeration specific to this text.

The "six cakras of the lotus" is an unusual enumeration; standard Mahāyoga systems typically count four or five cakras. This may reflect a system specific to the Mahāmudrā Tilaka tantra.

- The term "bhaga" throughout this passage is the Sanskrit word bhaga, used in its tantric sense as a polyvalent term meaning the vulva or womb as a sacred vessel, and simultaneously evoking sovereignty, fortune, and the dharmadhātu itself. The text is engaging in deliberate etymological and symbolic wordplay characteristic of the Yoginī tantras. This is left as "bhaga" in the translation to preserve the technical tantric register, with "precious vessel" and related glosses following the text's own explanation.

The syllables A and Hūṃ are treated here as primordial tantric seed-syllables embodying, respectively, the support and the supported, life-breath and exertion, moon and sun — standard Yoginī tantra symbolism. No domestication has been imposed.

The phrase rendered "the cause that unifies everything into one" translates a line meaning literally "the cause that makes all things one taste" or "one flavor," a technical expression for non-dual realization; "unifies into one" is the closest natural English equivalent that also reads aloud smoothly.

- The five male figures listed — Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Fierce One (Rudra/Śiva), Īśvara, and the Ever-Peaceful — are here being reinterpreted as correspondences to the five cakras and five families within the Heruka tantric system. Their listing is not an endorsement of their independent status but a standard tantric appropriation of Śaiva-Vaiṣṇava cosmological figures.

The six seed syllables yaṃ, raṃ, laṃ, baṃ, aṃ, haṃ are standard elemental and cakra-associated bījas in the tantric tradition and are left untranslated as they function as mantra syllables rather than lexical Tibetan.

The term "Cooked-Food" (btso blag) and the figures Caṇḍālī, Ḍombī, the Dancer, and so forth are low-caste or outcaste feminine figures characteristic of the Yoginī-tantra tradition, here elevated and identified with tantric family affiliations. The "sword family" (ral gri'i rigs) is an unusual designation; most five-family schemes use the karma family — this may reflect a six-family system specific to this text.

- The six goddesses enumerated here — Mother, Sister, Daughter, Wife, Bride, Sister-in-Law — are esoteric yoginī figures whose names in the preceding passage are Caṇḍālī, Ḍombī, the Dancer, the Cooked-Food Woman, the Skull-Bearer, and the Brahmin Woman. The present passage reassigns these roles in a deliberately transposed order, mapping them onto bodily channels, elements, and flavors according to the inner-tantric physiology of the text. The identifications are internally consistent but non-obvious; no emendation has been introduced.

The sacred sites listed in the final section — Uḍḍiyāna, Jālandhara, Pūlliramā, Kāmarūpa, and the rest — are the canonical pīṭha ("seat") and kṣetra ("field") pilgrimage sites of the yoginī-tantra tradition. The transliteration follows the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Indic place-names, which show some variation from standard Sanskrit forms.

- The passage is a body-maṇḍala list correlating sacred pilgrimage sites with anatomical locations on the yogic body, a well-attested genre in the Śākta-inflected Vajrayāna tantras (cf. Hevajratantra, Cakrasaṃvaratantra). The tree-names have been rendered in Sanskrit equivalents: śikara, śorisa, udumbara, pāṭali, aśvattha, and kesara are the standard botanical identifications found in the commentarial tradition; some uncertainty remains over "śikara," which may be a regional variant.

The phrase rendered "life-sacrifice" (srog gcod pa) literally means "cutting of life" and refers to a tantric offering context; in the commentarial tradition this is interpreted symbolically as the cutting of ego-clinging, though the text preserves the literal sacrificial register.

The eight goddess-types at the end (fierce one, mountain-peak, etc.) correspond to the eight ḍākinī or śakti categories of the charnel grounds in the Cakrasaṃvara cycle.

- The passage is a chapter from a Mahāyoga or Yoginītantra context describing inner fire-offering (homa) in terms of subtle-body physiology, followed by a rite of the five nectars. The fire-offering section maps the homa entirely onto the subtle body: the navel-wheel as the pit, the two faculties as fire-sticks, the aggregates as wood, and bodhicitta as the butter oblation. This is standard Yoginītantra inner-homa imagery.

The "fish" in the descent instruction likely refers to a specific subtle-body landmark, possibly the kanda or a channel-node identified by that name in this tradition; the exact referent is uncertain.

The five nectars are identified with the five buddha families and their respective substances — blood, semen, flesh, vajra-water, and great fragrance — following a standard Yoginītantra fivefold scheme in which each Tathāgata corresponds to a transgressive substance used in ritual.

The phrase rendered "daughters of the Enchantress" translates a term that could also mean "the daughter of the mind-captivating one"; the exact mythological referent is unclear in this context, and it may be a name for a class of ḍākinī.

The "three fruits" used in bodily purification likely refers to the Āyurvedic triphala compound, standard in tantric preliminary cleansing rites.

The "power-food of space" in the final line likely refers to a specific subtle or rarefied food substance known in tantric sādhana literature, sometimes identified with air or prana-sustaining practice; the precise referent depends on the broader commentary tradition of this text.

- The final section beginning with "In Oḍḍiyāna" introduces a passage of intentionally obscured "twilight language" (sandhibhāṣā), a deliberate esoteric code used in tantric literature. The strings of terms such as madana, kheṭara, śrāva, nirṃa, śuka, kuntu-ru, dudur, and kalinjara are technical terms from this register whose precise referents are uncertain and contextually dependent on oral lineage transmission. They are rendered here as transliterations preserving the source text's form, as any interpretive translation would project a specific exegetical tradition onto an open hermeneutical field.

The medicinal ingredients throughout — particularly tikarakuṭa, lāṭa, and nāgakeśara — are rendered by their Sanskrit botanical names where Tibetan provides a transliteration; some identifications of Tibetan terms with specific plant species admit more than one candidate in Āyurvedic literature.

The phrase "slain by the tip of a spear or by a sword — one of the five families" in the context of ritual extraction is a genuinely ambiguous passage; it may refer to an animal, a ritual category, or a symbolic register; the translation preserves the ambiguity of the source without resolution.

- This passage is a glossary of coded or twilight language (sandhābhāṣā), in which ordinary words are systematically replaced by secret equivalents used in tantric assemblies. Many of the terms transliterated from Sanskrit or other Indic languages (Diṇa-ḍireg, Bhahaka-ni, Jeghreka, Pukkaṣī, Caṇḍālī, Śvapaca-na, and so forth) are technical terms from mixed Sanskrit, Apabhraṃśa, or regional Indic registers standard to this genre; they are transliterated rather than translated, as the Tibetan itself treats them as foreign vocabulary to be decoded. The correspondence "rdza-mar" in the line "all, by name, is to be recalled as rdza-mar" remains in transliteration as the Tibetan appears to preserve a foreign or technical term without offering a Tibetan gloss. The final section on finger-mudrās signals a new chapter or sub-section; the phrase rendered "the bedridden, not to be found" reflects a literal reading of bsnyun rmed pa, likely a coded term for a specific tantric invitation gesture.
- The term rendered "navel hollow" (ཁྱེལ་ཁྱེལ་) and "shoulder" (ཁྱེལ་ཁྱེལ་) are colloquial anatomical terms whose precise referents are somewhat uncertain in context; "navel hollow" for ཁྱེལ་ཁྱེལ་ and "shoulder" for ཁྱེལ་ཁྱེལ་ represent reasonable readings given the body-part catalogue structure, but other interpretations are possible.

The word 𑖦𑖪𑖫𑖫𑖫𑖫 (tangku) designates a specific red flower used in tantric offering; the exact botanical identification is uncertain and the term is left transliterated.

The term རྩུབ་པོ་ (skull-cap or skull-bowl) worn on the head is a characteristic tantric ornament; "skull-cap" is used here to distinguish it from a hand-held skull-cup, though the Tibetan could admit either reading in principle.

- The passage describes a tantric visualization sequence in which goddesses emanate from successive "flavors" (ro, Sanskrit rasa) generated through union. The term "rubbing and method of rubbing" translates bsrub and bsrub thabs, likely referring to a ritual or meditative technique of friction or churning associated with the generation of these deities. The precise technical meaning of ta myu ra and ka ra in the eighth emanation is uncertain; these appear to be musical instruments (possibly a kind of lute or percussion instrument) whose Sanskrit forms are not fully clear from context. The "dharmodaya" rendered for chos 'byung is the dharmodaya triangle, a standard tantric symbol.
- The passage is a tantric liturgical text, most likely from a Cakrasaṃvara-cycle or related Mahāyoga/Yoginī-tantra corpus. Several points warrant notice.

The list of wrathful female deities beginning with "Terrifying One, Courageous One, Beer-Drinker..." through "Goat-Doe-Woman" represents a standard enumeration of the twenty-eight śakti attendants or pīṭha-goddesses associated with the maṇḍala. Their names are rendered semantically from Tibetan rather than by attested Sanskrit equivalents because the Sanskrit originals vary across recensions and are not unambiguously recoverable from this passage alone.

"Faculty-wood" renders 木匠心火, literally "the wood of the true faculty," a technical metaphor for the practice of tummo (caṇḍālī, the inner heat), in which two sticks rubbed together generate fire — here applied to the subtle-body practice of igniting the central-channel heat through breath and visualization.

"Caṇḍālī" is the standard Sanskrit term for the inner-heat practice (Tibetan: gtum mo); it has been retained as such rather than using the Tibetan in the translation body.

The exclamation "A-la-la-la / Ma-la-la-la" is a vocalization of bliss-cries common in Yoginī-tantra literature and is left untranslated as it is a sound-syllable utterance rather than lexical content.

- The four unions enumerated in this passage correspond to the four joys (joy, supreme joy, joy-apart-from-joy, co-emergent joy) as they unfold through the four stages of union: appearance, touch, union, and going. This is a standard Anuttarayogatantra completion-stage schema. The enumerations of four items within the second union (expansion, sufficiency, longing, arising, supreme joy) appear to list five items in the Tibetan, suggesting either a scribal irregularity or that one item is a qualifier rather than a separate member; the translation follows the text as given without harmonizing.

The term "uta" (rendered throughout as uta, from the Tibetan དུཌ་ཅུ་) is a technical tantric term referring to a specific type of blissful experience associated with the drop (bindu); it is left untranslated as it functions as a terminus technicus in this system and has no satisfactory standard English rendering.

- The term "Uta" appears in the preceding passage and is retained consistently here; it is a technical tantric term likely corresponding to a Sanskrit term such as "uttara" or a proper name within the system, and its exact referent remains text-specific.

The phrase "jewel palace" renders the Tibetan "rin chen mkhar," a technical term for a specific location in the vajra body, corresponding to a region at or near the tip of the generative organ in the subtle-body map.

"Romā and Ḍzinma" are the names of two of the three principal channels in this tantric system; Romā (Skt. Rasanā) and Ḍzinma (Skt. Lalanā) flank the central channel. The third, unnamed here as such, is the central channel (Skt. Avadhūtī), here identified with non-conceptuality.

The text ends mid-sentence, as the source passage itself breaks off at that point.

- The phrase rendered "the hollow lotus" reflects the Tibetan "padma kha sbub," literally "face-downward lotus," a technical term in this physiology for the downward-facing lotus at the navel. The upward movement described may refer to the reversal of the drop under meditative heat.

The "bhaga of a woman" is the Sanskrit technical term for the female sexual organ, retained here because the Tibetan "bha ga" is a direct loanword and the context is explicit tantric empowerment instruction; no euphemism has been substituted.

The "brahma-opening" refers to the aperture at the crown of the head, a standard channel-physiology term.

The sixteen items listed (light, power, cloud, etc.) correspond to the sixteen drops or aspects of bliss in the channel physiology of this tantra; their precise doctrinal identifications vary across commentaries and are not individually glossed here.

The final line of the passage is incomplete as given, ending mid-enumeration; the translation renders it faithfully up to that point.

- The chapter colophon marks this as Chapter Nineteen of the Mahāmudrā-tilaka (the Glorious Drop of Mahāmudrā), one of the principal tantric texts of this cycle.

The āli and kāli are technical tantric terms referring respectively to the vowel series and consonant series of the Sanskrit alphabet, which in this context function as esoteric designations for the white and red drops or the gnosis and method drops in the channels. They are left untranslated as proper tantric technical terms.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan; the text is corrupt or encoded and no standard Sanskrit reconstruction is certain.

The passage describing the various behavioral manifestations — naked, weeping, laughing, silent, and so forth — reflects the antinomian conduct (caryā) associated with Mahāyoga and related tantric traditions, in which the realized practitioner takes on diverse outward appearances as expressions of non-dual realization.

- The passage contains dense tantric syllabary and seed-syllable lists that function as esoteric technical specifications; they are rendered phonetically as transliteration rather than interpreted semantically, as is standard for such material.

The closing lines beginning "First draw Vairocana" describe a cryptographic spelling system for constructing deity-syllables by referring to positional coordinates within the Sanskrit consonant and vowel series (e.g., "the fifth of the fifth" means the fifth letter of the fifth consonantal group, and so on). This is a well-known tantric cipher convention. The passage breaks off mid-sentence in the source text, which accounts for the incomplete final lines.

The phrase rendered "seven sages" (Tib. thub pa bdun) literally means "seven sages or munis," here likely referring to seven buddha-figures whose seed syllables are being specified, not the Hindu rishis.

- This passage is a sustained cryptographic description of seed syllables and mantra components, identifying Sanskrit letters by their position within the traditional Sanskrit alphabet as classified in Tibetan phonological treatises: the consonantal classes are numbered, the vowels are numbered in sequence, sibilants and semi-vowels are specified by class and position, and additional marks such as bindu, visarga, and elemental seeds are noted. The "earth syllable," "mountain syllable," seeds of fire, wind, and sun are standard tantric designations for the consonants La, Ṣa, Ra, Ya, and Ha respectively, and for the anusvāra bindu. The "eighth of the class of Ya" in the context of the Tibetan alphabet ordering refers to the positional enumeration within the semi-vowel or final-consonant group. Decoding these syllables into specific Sanskrit phonemes requires access to the specific Sanskrit-Tibetan phonological table the text presupposes; the translation renders the positional descriptions faithfully without speculating on which exact Sanskrit syllables result in each case, as that would require a reconstruction beyond what the passage itself states explicitly.

- The phrase "the first of the Yi" at the opening refers to the continuation of the preceding syllabic-construction passage describing mantra formation; "Yi" refers to the vowel-series position carried over from the prior context. The text is a tantra in the tradition of Cakrasaṃvara-related yoginī tantras, and the deity list in the torma section names feminine forms of standard Hindu deities fully integrated into the tantric pantheon; the renderings given follow standard identifications in this literature. The "bhaga mudrā" is a tantric hand gesture; "bhaga" is left untranslated in keeping with the technical register of the original, which does not gloss it. The chapter colophon "Mahāmudrā-tilaka" translates the Tibetan "dpal phyag rgya chen po'i thig le," rendered consistently as "the glorious Mahāmudrā-tilaka."

- The phrase rendered "the white moon-holder" translates a term meaning the one who holds the rabbit or hare, a standard epithet for the moon in Indo-Tibetan literature; the moon is depicted as bearing a hare in its disc. The compound at the navel-moon passage is metrically dense and the syntax is elliptical; the translation follows the most natural doctrinal reading within the gaṇacakra ritual context.

The "hero of heroes in the center" and the surrounding passage on the hero's tongue, mouth, and the two navels is technical tantric body-maṇḍala language; the "hero" (dpa' bo, Skt. vīra) refers both to the male practitioner and to the deity embodied within the subtle body. The "center between the two navels" is a recognized anatomical-maṇḍala term in this literature.

The passage on mother, sister, daughter-in-law, and bride reflects standard antinomian gaṇacakra language describing ritual partners; no smoothing of the sense has been done.

- The term lāmā throughout this passage renders a Tibetan phonetic rendering of what appears to be a Sanskrit technical term for a class of yoginī or worldly goddess figure. The word is not the common Tibetan term for a spiritual teacher but a classification of ḍākinī type, used alongside Heruka and Vajravārāhī as names or epithets of specific categories of wrathful female deity. The phrase "sovereign of the world" renders Tib. 'jig rten dbang phyug, which is also an epithet of Śiva or Avalokiteśvara; in context it qualifies this lāmā-type figure.

The phrase rendered "the leather-vessel libation mudrā" renders pags pa bum pa spyi blugs, literally "leather pot overhead-pouring," referring to a ritual hand gesture whose precise form is described in the root tantra's commentarial tradition.

The final sentence "Then, moreover, what is to be further explained" is a transitional marker opening the next chapter and is included here as it appears in the source.

- The passage contains a sequence of highly technical Vajrayāna yogic instructions intertwined with siddhi-descriptions. Several phrases are deliberately cryptic and admit multiple interpretations within the commentarial tradition.

The term rendered "rocanā" in the first section refers to a substance derived from the female consort; it is a technical term in tantric physiology and has been left as such in keeping with the text's technical register.

The phrase "goddess, Gomatī" renders རྒྱ་མཚོ་མཆོག་མཚོ།, literally "far-seeing goddess" or "long-eyed goddess." This is likely an epithet rather than the proper name Gomatī; "far-seeing one" is used in the chapter colophon rendering but "Gomatī" is not asserted. The epithet is rendered descriptively.

The section dealing with "the life-wind and effort-wind" and the fourfold connections renders a deliberately compressed yogic technical passage; the Tibetan is genuinely elliptical and the rendering follows the most natural grammatical reading without imposing a single doctrinal interpretation.

The closing lines on "thirty-two knots" refer to the subtle-body channel system (nāḍī) and the connection of prāṇa within the central channel — a standard Vajrayāna subtle-physiology teaching. "Life-staff" renders རྒྱ་མཚོ་མཆོག་མཚོ། literally.

- The anatomical terms Rasanā and Lalanā refer to the right and left subtle channels (nāḍīs) flanking the central channel in tantric physiology; they are preserved as technical terms from the tradition rather than translated literally.

The "jewel-throat" is a tantric anatomical term likely referring to the tip of the vajra or the urethral aperture; its precise referent is contextually ambiguous and is left as rendered following standard Tibetan commentarial usage.

The mantra strings are transliterated as faithfully as the Tibetan script permits; they are ritual dhāraṇī sequences and are not translated.

The expression "sixteen" and "sun" throughout this passage refer to a specialized tantric numerological and physiological framework in which the sixteen vowels or phases of the moon correspond to aspects of the drop and the central channel; this is esoteric shorthand presupposing the preceding chapters' cosmology.

- The phrase "neither wind nor sleep" in the context of rlung ma gnyid ma yod pa renders a technical yogic statement that when one abides stably in the channel-wheel, the wind-energies are controlled and sleep is absent; this is a standard Vajrayāna physiological claim about

advanced practice.

The term "secret nostril" for *ri rab rtse mo gsang sna'o* is unusual; *gsang sna* can mean "secret nostril" or, in some tantric anatomical schemas, a hidden orifice at the crown. The cosmological-anatomical parallel being drawn maps the body onto the cosmos, so the summit of Mount Meru corresponds to a subtle bodily location, likely the crown aperture or a related point.

The colophon phrase "*dang po'i dang po grub pa*" — "the primary, primary accomplishment" or "the first, first completion" — is an unusual tantra colophon designation rather than a standard chapter closing. Its precise significance within the *Mahāmudrāṭīlaka*'s organizational scheme is uncertain.

- The colophon names present some difficulty. "*Prajñā Guhyavadana*" renders the Sanskrit implied by "*dpal shes rab gsang ba'i zhal*," literally "glorious wisdom-secret face," which likely represents a Sanskrit name such as *Prajñāguhyamukha* or similar. The two Tibetan collaborators' names, Kama Chökyi Yeshe and Phyugtshams Drakbom Arhat, are rendered phonetically as they appear to be proper names rather than transparent epithets. The term "ཐུང་པོའི་ཐུང་པོ་གུར་པ་" (*bindu*, Skt. *bindu*) is rendered as "Bindu" in the title to preserve the tantric technical term, as it refers to the seminal drop or point of essence central to this text's teaching.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.